



**Plasto
& Company** Livestock and Property

Livestock
Ross Plasto
0428 636 289

Property Management
Emma Cenzato
0418 636 254

Raine and Horne
Residential & Rural Properties
Gary Francis
0428 459 830

Wellington & District LEADER

Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Eucharéna, Geurie,
Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbron and Yeoval districts.

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Inc GST



WELLINGTON
RACE CLUB

**Wellington
Boot
Carnival**

**Time to book
your Boot Tent**

Carmen Gain - our Woman of the Year - P3



Men's Shed builds shop to sell their craft - P 4

Yeoval Central School leadership training - P 5



Rooftop solar to save \$\$\$ on electricity

IT'S NOT very often a crane pierces the skyline of Wellington but last week it became a familiar sight.

The Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club (WSMC) is installing a brand new solar electrical system on the rooftop after electrical infrastructure failure of the original system last October.

Club general manager Stephen Hodge said the club gained an insurance claim in excess of \$500,000 after a fire in the roof last October.

"Our insurance company and broker sought advice from NSW Country Solar - Redfern Power when assessing the damage," Mr Hodge said.

"Some structural and heat damage in and on the roof was found and we needed to remove more than 200 solar panels, plus the wiring."

Some 900 square metres of roofing is being replaced.

"Damage under the roof luckily was minor and quickly fixed," Mr Hodge said.

The crane was used last week to lift damaged roofing down and new panels up, and will be used again at different times when lifting the new panels.

Mr Hodge said the available roof space will now fit more than 300 solar panels.

"With the panels, Redferns will also install enough batteries for us to gain in excess of 280-plus kilowatts of power," he said.

"We already have four very large inverters and while solar will provide daytime electricity, we believe the batteries will keep the lights and power on overnight."

Mr Hodge said the club has not been on solar since the fire last October.

Power bill more than \$240,000

We haven't had any solar since October last year.

"Our power bills have gone through the roof."

The club's electricity bill for a year without solar would run at between \$240,000 to \$250,000, he said.

"So you can see why we want to move to a full solar/battery system."

Mr Hodge said the work will take about six weeks to fulfil and work was now into the third week.

"The roof is now ready for panels to be laid," he said.

"And with these panels we are installing bird protection, so we don't have the pigeons which are a nuisance throughout town buildings."

Car park power

A future project the club board is investigating is to cover the car park with solar.

"This would provide more electricity and also undershade parking for members and visitors," Mr Hodge said

"It is envisaged the panels would produce close to 90-plus kilowatts and would also power two electric vehicle power stations."



**Inside
this
week**



Record flood of 1926 - Page 9

Calling emerging artists

Seniors Festival Councillors’ BBQ
SENIORS ARE warmly invited to the 2026 Councillors’ BBQ for a relaxed and friendly get-together.

Enjoy a free lunch, meet your local Councillors, and take the opportunity to share your ideas, ask questions, or simply have a chat in a casual setting. It’s a great chance to connect with others in the community and find out what’s happening in your local area.

Today at 12pm to 2pm, Thursday, March 12, at 48 Swift Street, Wellington.

Strong seasons start with smart drought preparation

Drought-ready isn’t a reaction, it’s a strategy. Plan ahead while conditions are still manageable.

Taking action today will help protect your home, farm, or business if and when conditions worsen.

Practical templates and resources are available to help you with: Drought decision making; On-farm drought management; On-farm drought advice and resources.

Get started by googling: Climate and emergencies for primary producers NSW

Community survey open online now

Phone calls as part of the Community Insight Survey are now complete, and our online survey is now open.

This survey is your chance to share what matters most, tell us about your experiences with Council’s services and facilities, and help shape how well we’re meeting the community’s expectations.

Completing this survey will take approximately 10 minutes, and your feedback is greatly valued.

Start the survey now by googling: DRC YourSay Community Insights Survey This survey closes at 9am on Monday 30 March 2026.

Calling emerging artists

Council is looking for the next round of emerging artists to join the HomeGround program.

Tina Pech was a HomeGround artist in 2025 and shared the following testimonial as to why artists should apply.

“HomeGround was a fulfilling and empowering experience. Seeing the visual culmination of my work in the gallery space was an emotionally awesome

moment.” “I am sincerely grateful for this experience and highly recommend the program,” she said.

Eligible artists must live within a 200-kilometre radius of Dubbo.

HomeGround applications close Friday, April 10. For information and application forms visit Western Plains Cultural Centre’s website: www.westernplainsculturalcentre.org

One tiny chip, a huge step in pet safety

All cats and dogs must be microchipped:

- * By 12 weeks old, or
 - * Before being sold or adopted
- Whichever comes first.

Whoever sells, gives away or rehomes the pet must ensure it is microchipped first. Though it is the responsibility of all pet sellers and owners to be informed of requirements.

Next steps? Within 28 days after micro-chipping takes place you can register your pet on NSW Pet Registry.

Transfer of ownership or change of address or details can be updated on NSW Pet Registry afterwards to ensure your pet

can be returned home to you if lost.

Free screening of Just A Farmer

As part of ‘Big Tech Big Ideas’, attend a special and free screening of Just A Farmer - Feature Film.

The Australian film is heartfelt and powerful, capturing the resilience, struggles and triumphs of rural life.

Black Box Theatre at Western Plains Cultural Centre, 76 Wingewarra Street, Dubbo. Thursday, March 26. Arriving 5pm for a 6pm screening.

Following the screening, hear from Warren Davies - The Unbreakable Farmer.

Warren brings lived experience, practical insight and a deeply authentic message about resilience, recovery and hope in rural Australia.

Secure your seat to this free event at by calling DRC on 68014000.

The screening is proudly sponsored by Dubbo Regional Council and Narromine Shire through the Australian Government Future Drought Fund and NSW Government Regional Drought Resilience program.

Josh Black

Police issue warning over authority scams targeting multicultural communities

POLICE ARE warning the public about a number of “authority scams” targeting members of the community.

Officers across several Police Area Commands have received reports of the scams, with some victims reporting losses of more than \$50,000.

The scams appear to be targeting multicultural communities, including the Chinese, Vietnamese and Indian communities.

Victims have reported receiving calls from someone claiming to be an official from an embassy, or police force, before being told that their passport and personal information were found on a recently arrested individual overseas. The victim is then threatened with extradition or deportation to face the criminal justice system overseas unless they pay an amount of money.

Some victims have reported receiving multiple calls over several days and via different phone apps including Viber and WhatsApp.

Cybercrime Squad Commander Detective Acting Superintendent Jason Smith said scammers use many tactics to scare victims into handing over their personal information and money. “Calls, and threats made, may appear real, but they are not. These people are only trying to take

advantage of your fears,” he said.

“We understand people who receive such calls will be scared and concerned – if you do receive one of these calls, hang up and report it immediately.

“Some of these victims are vulnerable members of our community who are losing thousands of dollars of their savings. Anyone who thinks they may have received a scam call, or has fallen victim to a scam, is urged to report it.”

Mr Smith said scam calls don’t always come from a foreign number, they are often spoofed to appear to come from an Australian landline or mobile phone number.

Advice for the community:

- * Do not share personal information or financial details over the phone
- * Do not transfer funds to people you do not know
- * Do not respond to threats or demands for payment
- * Do not visit websites or click links provided by scammers

Anyone who believes they may have been a victim of a fraud or scam is urged to report the matter via the Report Cyber portal or at their local police station or Crime Stoppers on 1800 333 000.

Funding for Australian-first alliance boosting access to life-saving clinical cancer trial

FUNDING IS being provided by the state government to boost an Australian-first alliance that’s fast-tracking cancer patients across NSW onto potentially life-saving early-stage clinical trials.

Coordinated by the Garvan Institute of Medical Research with funding support from the NSW Government’s Cancer Institute NSW, the NSW Early Phase Clinical Trials Alliance (NECTA) is a state-wide network of doctors, researchers, clinical trial specialists, and hospitals who are collaborating to boost access to early-stage clinical trials that are critical to successful treatment.

The government invested \$450,000 into the Cancer Institute this year to fund NECTA for the 2025/26 and 2026/27 financial years, taking total investment in the program to \$975,000.

The investment has helped bolster the annual number of trials available from 150 to more than 180 over the past three years.

Since its establishment in 2017, NECTA has seen a steady increase in the number of people accessing early-stage clinical trials across an increasing number of cancer types.

More than 800 patients have been able to access early-stage clinical trials through NECTA.

The trials are the first step in testing new therapies in humans, following extensive laboratory and pre-clinical testing to both accelerate research

and offer hope and a treatment pathway to those with limited options.

NECTA accelerates patient access to world class trials through a streamlined screening and referral system, requiring only a blood test instead of the more invasive tumour DNA testing.

As well as opening doors to world-class clinical trials, the network provides access to trials at a wider array of hospitals, in regional and rural NSW, with around one in four patients who access these trials living outside of metropolitan areas.

Farmers warn of conservation ‘land grab’

Wentworth Group pulling wool over eyes in “sneaky attempt to impose national standards

A CONTROVERSIAL proposal from an anti-farming environmental group risks handing control of private land to government under the guise of conservation.

NSW Farmers’ conservation and resource management Committee chair Bronwyn Petrie said the Wentworth Group of Scientists’ “Blueprint for a Healthy Country and Thriving Regions” to farmers was deeply disingenuous.

“The Wentworth Group is promising funding and support while quietly setting up a pathway for government control of private land,” Mrs Petrie said.

“That is not partnership, it’s a land grab

dressed up as conservation.

“They keep saying ‘we’ as though they’re standing with farmers, but the end goal is to turn productive agricultural land into locked up private reserves, jeopardising food and fibre security.”

Mrs Petrie said attempts to tie state land use decisions to national environmental laws were particularly concerning.

“This is just a sneaky attempt to impose national standards designed for matters of national significance onto local farming decisions, where they simply don’t belong.” Mrs Petrie said.

“The idea that outside groups need to help farmers ‘understand’ their own land

shows exactly where this is heading.

“It shifts decision making away from landholders, many of whom have generations of experience on their land, and hands it to desktop ‘experts’.

“This proposal entrenches the view that farmers should give up productive land to offset urban and infrastructure development elsewhere, and all it does is undermine trust and send us back to the days of pitting farmers against the environment.”

NSW Farmers has called on governments to reject any approach that removes control from landholders or treats agricultural land as expendable.

Wellington & District LEADER

In Memory of Beryl O’Brien

Covering news and views particularly from within the Wellington region, which now runs from Eucharéena to Elong Elong within Dubbo Regional Council Local Government Area.

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Editor: Mark Griggs
0456 940 999
email: mark@wdleader.news

Advertising Manager
Sharon Wilson
0407 935 998
email: sharon@wdleader.news

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Carmen Gain recognised as the 2026 Dubbo electorate Woman of the Year

WELLINGTON'S CARMEN GAIN has been announced as the Dubbo electorate Woman of the Year at the NSW Women of the Year Awards in Sydney.

The Women of the Year Awards celebrate local champions, advocates and trailblazers who make a difference to their local community and recognise the outstanding contributions of women and girls across the state.

Member for the Dubbo electorate Dugald Saunders said the annual awards are an important opportunity to acknowledge the women who make a meaningful difference across NSW every day.

"Our community is incredibly proud to see Carmen honoured at the NSW Women of the Year Awards.

Her work as a tireless volunteer in the Wellington community and as a dedicated teacher, have delivered a lasting impact locally, and this recognition is thoroughly deserved," Mr Saunders said.

"Carmen is an active and generous member of the St Mary's Catholic School community, she gives her time freely to netball, touch football and soccer, has been president of the Wellington Amateur Swimming Club for the past six years and also volunteers with Western Area Swimming



State member for Dubbo Dugald Saunders presents Carmen Gain her Dubbo Electorate 2026 Woman of the Year award.

Association", he said.

Carmen's dedication and generosity to the Wellington Redbacks Rugby Club saw her recognised as one of two "Club Persons of the Year" for 2025 and she also contributes annually to the Wellington Eisteddfod.

"She is not only an incredibly community minded volunteer and dedicated teacher, but also wife to Patrick, mum to Hughie, Harry and Elsie, and I am thrilled to be able to recognise her with this award", Mr Saunders said.

"It is clear that Carmen has demonstrated excellence with

genuine community service and has exemplified the strength, capability, and generosity that define the women in our community and across NSW".

Carmen is a regular contributor to the Wellington & District Leader providing photos and reports on the various sporting event she may be attending on the day, particularly Friday through to Sunday each weekend, Winter, Spring, Summer or Autumn – Carmen is normally at one or three events.

On behalf of the WDL fraternity, a hearty congratulations.

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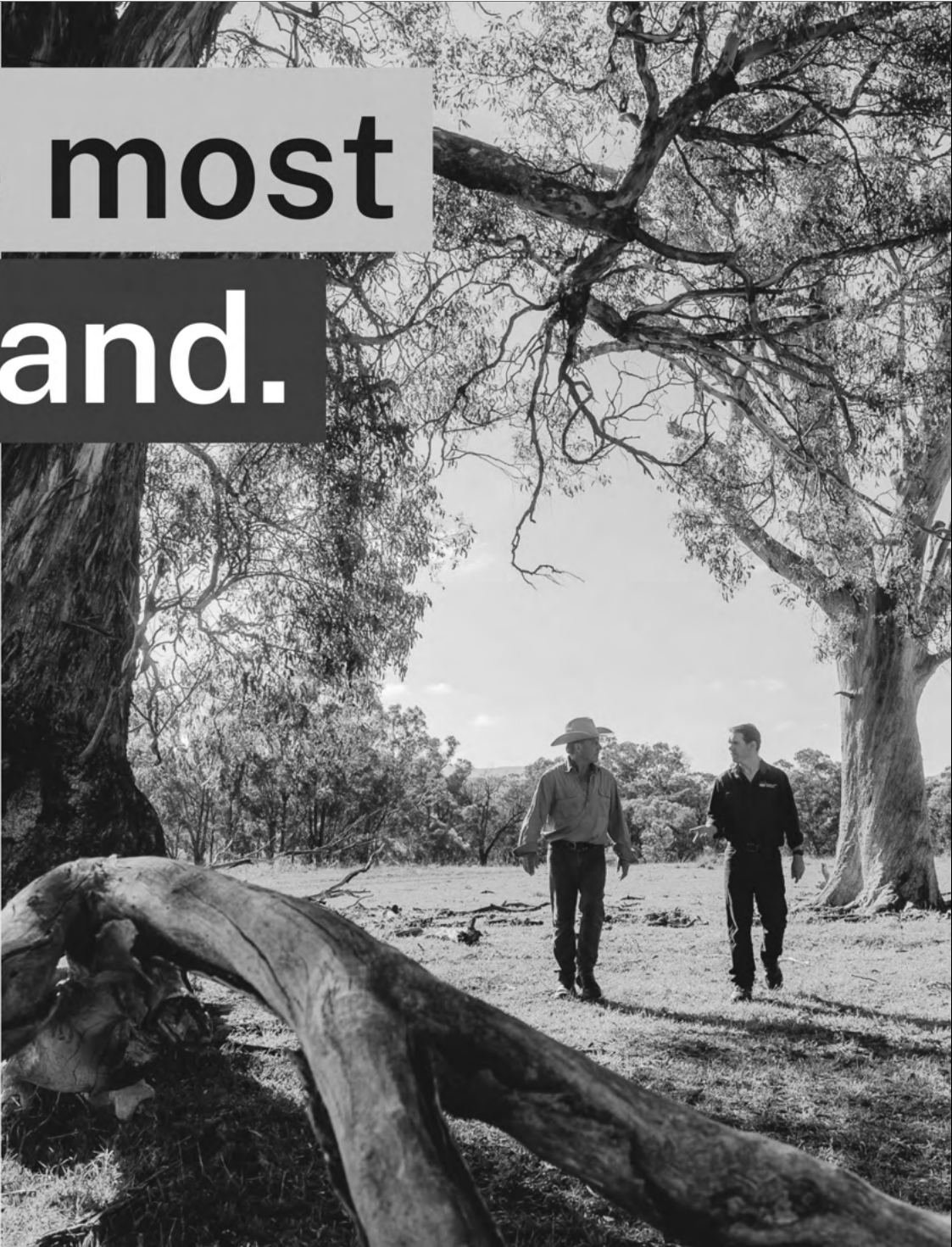
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Men’s Shed tea room makes way for new display showcase

THERE’S A lot of movement at Wellington Men’s Shed in Gobolion Street. And don’t worry, things are moving quick. It’s time to showcase the craftsmanship that is being carried out within, so the old lunch room is being renovated into a showroom/shop. The Shed’s Jim Titley reports that the Shed needs room to display the goods that are made and repaired so they can be sold. Items such as camp ovens, garden windmills, dog kennels, garden seats and pre-loved tools are just some of the items for sale. Pictured are Ron, Bill and Graham deciding on how best to build the door and the wheel chair access ramp during the renovation.



Australian Government

The Help to Buy Scheme is now here

With the new **Help to Buy Scheme**, the Australian Government can contribute up to 40% of the purchase price of a home.

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It’s a pathway to home ownership backed by Government.

To see if you’re eligible visit firsthomebuyers.gov.au



Authorised by the Australian Government, Canberra

Happy Lions on Safari Month to International Lions

TO CELEBRATE Safari Month, Wellington Lions will be holding a free Sausage Sizzle outside their preloved book shop, 44 Warne street, (Kimbell’s Building) between 10am and 1pm this Saturday, March 14. While they cook your free sausage sanga have a chat with a Lion to see what you can do for your town and community to help different Lions Foundations.



At their bi-monthly meetings your local club decides where money raised from fund raising barbeques and their Preloved Book shop is distributed. They get together for a chat at 5.30pm before the 6pm meeting on the second and fourth Mondays of each month in the Private Room at Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club. As always, new members are welcome – Wellington Lions Club has been going 68 years but could do with some new blood – let’s keep it going! Pop into their preloved book shop to see the full list of donations given in the last calendar year and while there, pick up a bargain. All priced books/jigsaw puzzles, DVDs and CDs are half the marked price, everything else is only \$2 with another bargain being 10 dvds/cds for \$10! Choose your favourites from the huge range of good quality items that are in stock, and a thank you to sister Lions Club Kellyville and all the people who donate different items weekly. The preloved book shop is open Thursday to Saturday 10am to 2pm.

First stage of golf clubhouse redevelopment ready for tendering

THE FIRST stage of Wellington Golf Club’s refurbishment upgrade is being progressed.

Promised with the club’s amalgamation with Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club, construction of an outdoor shaded external decking surrounding the clubhouse is now open for tender.

Soldiers Club general manager Stephen Hodge said the Development Application had been approved by council and we are now calling for expressions of interest in the construction of the decking, plus internal toilets and amenities as well as a golf administration office.

“The biggest plan is the decking,” he said.

“It is quite a large deck but the infrastructure had been designed so in the future, walls can be built on the outside edge so that the whole building can be built-in and covered, ready for an internal remodeling with extra floor space.

“Then rebuild the existing internal area with a lot of extra floor space.

“We can turn this into a large modern club,” he said.

In the meantime the decking which will be covered and could be used for entertainment, family functions and relaxing Sunday afternoon outdoors with barbecue utilising some modern outdoor furniture.

“I want to install a play area as well to



encourage family use,” he said.

“Then there is the opportunity of providing food from Friday to Sunday, as well as spreading the word to the council tourist park next door which should increase food sales as well.”

Mr Hodge said the course had been upgraded with irrigation now completed.

“With money leftover we are looking at installing another large water tank, and also looking at enhancing new irrigation in front of tee areas.

“We have just completed installing new beer lines and extended the cool room and foresee these as the start of greater things to come for the club.”

Mr Hodge said the club had gained enquiries from people wanting to conduct functions out there including weddings.

“We could make these a more rustic atmosphere where people could be married in picturesque areas on the course and have the reception within or outside the club house.”

Regional NSW dominates top 10 electorates with rooftop solar

Dubbo state electorate is well among them.

LATEST DATA reveals households and businesses in regional NSW are leading the charge in rooftop solar adoption, accounting for nine of the top ten electorates for installations.

NSW leads the country in rooftop solar with more than one-million homes and businesses that now have rooftop solar – a third of all NSW homes.

When the sun is shining, rooftop solar is producing more power than all NSW coal fired power stations.

Dubbo electorate is the sixth highest in the state.

In the final quarter of last year, rooftop solar and solar farms

combined provided 32 per cent of the state’s electricity.

The Barwon electorate in the state’s north-west has emerged as the leader with 24,537 homes and businesses with rooftop solar, followed closely by the Northern Rivers region with 22,743 in Ballina and 22,162 in Lismore.

While Riverstone in Sydney’s Northwest ranks as the fifth highest electorate for solar uptake, it takes the number one spot for battery installations in the country with around 1500 households opting to capture their rooftop solar for use around the clock.

An average four-person household with a 6.6kW solar system could save up to \$1400 per year.

Regional NSW does not need another feral pig review

FERAL PIGS are exploding across NSW and farmers are paying the price, according to opposition spokesman on agriculture Brendan Moylan.

And minister Moriarty is announcing yet, another review, he said.

“If nearly 250,000 pigs have been culled and the problem is still this bad, that tells you the current approach is nowhere near enough, and is having no impact on the breeding cycle,” he said.

Minister for Agriculture Tara Moriarty had announced nearly 250,000 pigs had been culled across NSW over the last three years, barely putting a dent into pig populations.

Mr Moylan said announcing yet another review and then quoting mediocre numbers from the past three years doesn’t hide the reality on the ground.

He has long argued around 80 per cent of pig population numbers need to be culled per year via targeted local campaigns.

“Minister Moriarty can announce reviews,

roundtables and ‘improved coordination’ all she likes but farmers and regional communities don’t need another study,” he said.

“We need helicopters in the air, boots on the ground and pigs being shot, baited and trapped at pace and scale.

“It is simple really, until there is a serious increase in the feral pig control budget and sustained, large-scale aerial and ground operations, feral pigs will continue to run rampant across NSW.

“Every month the government spends talking about ‘making management bigger and better’ is another month pigs are breeding, destroying crops, damaging native vegetation, river systems and spreading significant disease risk.

“Enough talk, enough reviews. Stop hiding behind announcements and start backing farmers and regional communities with the funding and decisive action they deserve,” he said.

Rebate open for eID readers

Rebates are now open for producers and livestock agents across NSW to gain affordable access to eID equipment.

Eligible producers and livestock agents can claim a 50 per cent rebate (up to \$1500) on the purchase of a handheld eID reader.

The latest round of funding is being offered to producers and livestock agents who may have missed out on the initial infrastructure rebate scheme in 2023.

Producers can use electronic identification (eID) tags to record individual animal data to inform breeding and

selection decisions, helping to deliver measurable returns.

The rebate is available for handheld readers purchased on or after October 3, 2023.

The rebate can be claimed from 2 March 2026.

The eID equipment rebate will close on 31 August 2026, or earlier if funding is fully allocated so don’t delay in submitting your rebate application.

Contact your nearest LLS office for ideas on how to get started with eID.

At Yeoval Central School

Student Leadership Training

Our 2026 student leaders recently participated in an empowering workshop on student leadership, facilitated by Mrs Tremain.

During this engaging session, they explored the vital qualities of effective leadership and discussed the significant impact that positive role models have within the school community.

The workshop provided them with practical strategies to inspire and support their

peers, reinforcing the importance of integrity, empathy and responsibility.

Through interactive activities and thoughtful discussions, the student leaders developed a deeper understanding of how they can contribute to creating a respectful and inclusive environment for everyone.

They also created their own vision statement.

This experience has equipped them with the confidence and skills needed to lead by example throughout the year ahead.



TOOHEYS

Wellington & District LEADER







Are you up for the challenge?

Wellington Boot 2026

TOOHEYS

GUYS AND DOLLS

CHALLENGE

If you're aged 18 to 30 years you're eligible to enter the 2026 Tooheys Guys and Dolls Challenge at the Wellington Boot Racing Carnival, Friday, April 10 and Sunday April 12.

Entry forms available at Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club or on the club's website.

You must attend the Calcutta 6pm Saturday night (April 11) to win a horse, and gain free entry to Sunday's Boot Day, as guest of Wellington Race Club including lunch and drinks.

Prizes to challengers who pick 1st, 2nd, 3rd placings

Infuriating chain gang Great Western Highway is not fit for purpose – issue taken to prime minister

THE CLOSURE of the Great Western Highway this week is simply infuriating.

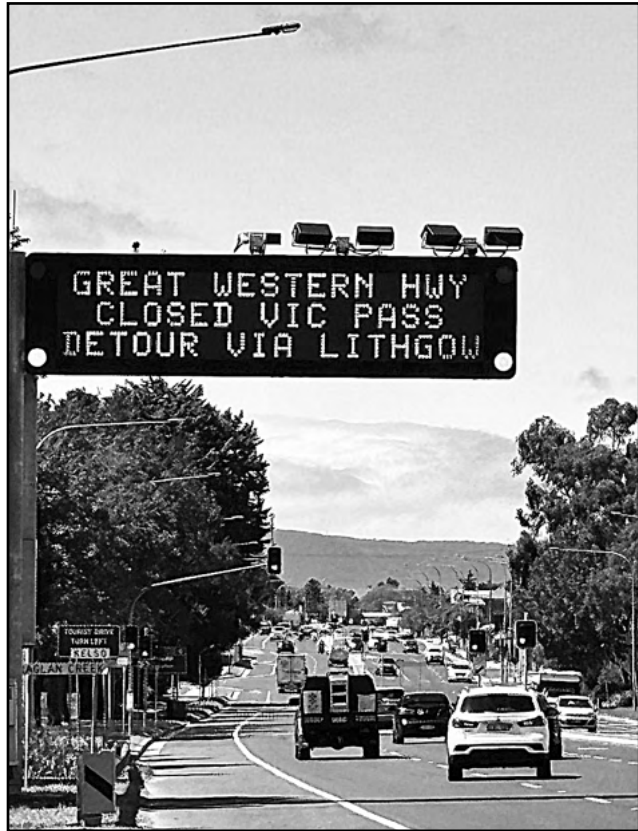
The NSW Government has closed both lanes between Lithgow and Mount Victoria until further notice, with diversions in place.

Defects were identified over the past week at Mitchell's Causeway, also known as the Convict Bridge, which was built in the 19th Century.

I'm here to tell you this really gets to me.

The day after the closure, I took the issue directly to the Prime Minister in Question Time.

After pointing out how ludicrous it was to be relying on a bridge built by convicts as our main access road, I asked



The Convict Bridge at Mitchell's Causeway.
(Supplied: Blue Mountains Historical Society archives)

him whether he would put pressure on, and work with the NSW Government, to build a genuine expressway through to Sydney.

Instead of answering, the Prime Minister flicked it to the Infrastructure Minister whose answer was disappointing.

There was no commitment. It's a shame that question time isn't answer time.

How could we have a situation in the modern Australia of 2026, where the main access in and out of the Central West of our state is reliant on a bridge that was built by a convict chain gang in the early 1830s?

This situation is disgraceful and further proof, if you ever needed it, that the Great Western Highway is not fit for purpose.

All of the major parties have let us down for decades on this, and it is simply not good enough.

All we get is broken promises, empty announcements, cheap talk and small change.

It seems that we can build expressways and tunnels right throughout Sydney, up the Pacific Highway and down on the South Coast.

Yet, in the Central West, we're reliant on a convict bridge



**The
Gee
Report**

Andrew Gee
Federal Member for Calare

built by a chain gang. You cannot make this up.

Maintaining the rage to fix rural doctor shortage crisis

In Parliament last week, I spoke about the rural doctor shortage crisis that is failing our communities.

The 'sandstone curtain' of the Great Dividing Range doesn't just divide city and country, it divides our access to affordable healthcare.

The further away you live from a city, the shorter your life expectancy.

The fact is that people in our most remote areas are dying 15 years earlier than their city cousins.

Government changes to the Distribution Priority Areas in 2022 saw a great movement of overseas trained doctors away from the bush, fuelling the rural doctor shortage crisis.

I introduced the Doctors for the Bush Bill 2024 to remedy this unfairness and to restore the priority that country areas should have for accessing a GP.

Unfortunately, when it was put to a vote, none of the major parties supported it, including the so-called 'guardians of the bush', the National Party.

So, the rural doctor shortage crisis continues.

The Salvation Army's Social Justice Stocktake 2025, found almost half the population of Calare believe access to health care is a major issue.

And 40 per cent felt they had waited longer than acceptable for a GP appointment.

Rural postcodes have been abandoned by the government and it's not good enough.

Country people demand and deserve nothing less than equity in access to doctors, medical services and affordable healthcare.



with Mathew Dickerson, Axxis Comworld

SOMETIMES WE see a product or invention and think, "That's so obvious! Why didn't I think of that?"

Wheels on suitcases are the classic example. Once someone finally attached little rollers to luggage, the whole world collectively wondered how we'd spent decades dragging heavy bags through airports without them.

But not every clever invention is waiting around for someone to have a light-bulb moment. Some ideas have existed for years but they simply couldn't happen until the technology finally caught up.

Cyclists know this story all too well.

The bane of every rider's existence is the flat tyre. I've raced bikes most of my life, and I've tried just about every supposed solution that promised to end punctures forever.

Solid tyres were one attempt. Sure, they couldn't go flat, but they were heavy and rode like you'd filled your wheels with concrete.

Kevlar linings were supposed to stop

6 THURSDAY, MARCH 12, 2026 WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER

thorns, but they were far from foolproof. Thorn-proof tubes added weight. Tubeless tyres helped with small punctures but weren't perfect either. Even airless tyres have come and gone in experimental forms.

Yet despite all the ingenuity and materials science thrown at the problem, most cyclists still ride on pneumatic tyres – similar to that first design from 1888.

Which means that when things go wrong, you need a way to put the air back in.

That meant carrying a small hand pump, but no matter how efficient they have become, pumping a road tyre back up is still a surprisingly energetic workout.

CO₂ cartridges appeared in the nineties. They're incredibly fast and popular with racers because they can inflate a tyre in seconds. The downside is they're single-use and you lack any control.

And now, a whole new category of gadget has emerged: the micro inflator.

These devices are essentially tiny electric air compressors small enough to fit in a jersey pocket. At first glance they look almost

too small to be believable. Yet press a button and they whirr into life, pushing air into a tyre with surprising authority.

What makes them interesting is that this isn't just a clever idea finally being noticed. Cyclists have wanted something like this for years. The concept was obvious. The problem was the technology simply didn't exist.

Only recently have several advances converged to make it possible.

Inside these pocket-sized inflators is a tiny piston compressor driven by a brushless electric motor spinning at astonishing speed - often tens of thousands of revolutions per minute.

That motor compresses air in a miniature chamber and forces it into the tyre through a high-pressure hose.

Add to that modern lithium batteries capable of delivering bursts of high power, tiny digital pressure sensors that measure tyre pressure in real time, and a small computer chip that automatically stops the pump when the desired pressure is reached.

Ten years ago, this sort of device would

have been more than three times the size.

Today, it fits comfortably in your palm.

Press a button and it buzzes away like a cordless drill for half a minute while your tyre quietly returns to life.

No frantic pumping. No freezing CO₂ cartridges. Just a short mechanical whirr and you're ready to ride again.

More interesting, though, is what these little pumps represent.

They're a reminder that innovation doesn't always arrive as a sudden spark of genius.

Sometimes the idea is already obvious. People have been imagining it for years.

The real breakthrough happens when technology finally catches up.

The wheel on a suitcase was simple.

But a compressor in your pocket? That one had to wait for the future to arrive.

I am feeling generous this year! Send a question or comment about this article to ask@techtalk.digital and the first 10 e-mails will receive a FREE Tech Talk compilation book! Get curious, involved, get a freebie!

Easter egg hunt, yabby races, bucking bull and beards a flowing all return to Stuart Town on Easter Saturday

IT'S ON again at Stuart Town on Easter Saturday, It's the Man From Ironbark Festival on April 4.

Gates open from 9am with all roads leading to Stuart Town for the much-anticipated Man From Ironbark Festival returning with greater excitement and scale than ever before.

This year's event promises a memorable experience for all, welcoming visitors back to both the recreation ground and, for the first

time in over five years, the main street.

With an affordable entry fee of just \$2 per person—and free admission for children aged five and under - the festival offers unbeatable value.

Whether you are a long-time attendee or a first time visitor, this year's festival is certainly not one to miss.

Featuring this year are 'Free' Jumping Castle and Slide plus Bush Poetry - Street Parade

- Market Stalls - Yabby Races - Beard Competition - Free Bucking Bull - Free Children's Train - Reptile Show- Meet the Dinosaurs - Car and Bike Show - Free Face Painting - Food Stalls - Art Exhibition - Live Music -Busking Competition - Free Merry Go-Round - Sheep Dog Trials – and the famous Easter Egg Hunt. Don't miss it.



Minister ignores the regions in budget estimates

THE STATE Government has again shown where its priorities lie - and it's not with regional NSW.

During Budget Estimates on Tuesday, the Minister for Regional Transport and Roads refused to even acknowledge the ongoing closure of the Great Western Highway at Mount Victoria, which has left western NSW cut off and motorists stranded.

Member for Bathurst Paul Toole said it is clearer now more than ever where the minister's priorities lie.

"This Minister needs to change her title to Metro Roads, because regional roads clearly aren't on her radar," Mr Toole said.

Serious traffic disruptions have now dragged on for days after the Great Western Highway was closed indefinitely at Mount Victoria, crippling freight movements and leaving thousands of motorists stuck in gridlock. During the hearing, NSW Nationals Upper House MP Nichole Overall pressed the Minister on why she had not even

made a public statement five days into the crisis. "The Minister dismissed the question, claiming it was simply 'an operational-matter'. Yet the same Minister had no hesitation turning up to a photo opportunity in Sydney on Monday for the M12 motorway."

Mrs Overall said the contrast showed exactly how the Minns Labor Government treats regional communities.

"This is a disgusting display of inequality between the city and the bush," Mrs Overall said. If this road was in Newcastle, Sydney or Wollongong we would have received constant updates and every resource would be thrown at reopening it."

"The state is effectively cut in half and the Minister is refusing to provide updates or even a timeline for the hundreds of thousands of people affected."

Mr Toole said the situation was even more frustrating because warnings about the fragility of the historic Convict Bridge were raised months ago and ignored.

Mitchell's Causeway also known as Convict Bridge was built 194 years ago for horse and cart usage. Now the same hand-built bridge is carrying modern freight loads of up to 50 tonnes along with thousands of vehicles every day.

The Blackheath and District Chamber of Commerce sent a letter to the Department and the Minister on 19 December 2025, calling for a full structural investigation into the durability and remaining life of the nearly 200-year-old bridge. The letter warned Transport for NSW must "acknowledge the real possibility of failure" given the structure was never designed for modern traffic loads.

The request went unanswered.

Mr Toole said regional communities deserve transparency and leadership.

"The NSW Labor Government is leaving regional communities high and dry," Mr Toole said. Regional communities rely on this highway every single day and they should not be ignored."

Restorative Yoga third Sunday of month 9am to 10.30am

Seniors Tai Chi every Friday 9:30am

Open Sundays 1pm-4pm

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Andrew GEE MP

INDEPENDENT FEDERAL MEMBER FOR CALARE

Runs on the Board for the Wellington Area

- ✓ \$9.5 million to build a new, purpose built wing focused on dementia and palliative care at Maranatha House
- ✓ Secured upgrade of Wellington Hospital Emergency Department
- ✓ \$560,000 for Stuart Town water security project
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project Stage Two
- ✓ \$1.1 million for Ponto Falls Road upgrade
- ✓ \$650,000 for upgrades at Wellington Christian School
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project
- ✓ \$2.02 million for replacing the Terrabella, Burrendong and Gundy Creek Bridges
- ✓ \$738,000 for the Cameron Park footbridge
- ✓ \$200,000 for improvements at Kennard Park
- ✓ Video link for Wellington Court House

- ✓ \$26,700 for the Driver Reviver site at the Wellington Information Centre
- ✓ \$1.176 million for improvements at Wellington Caves
- ✓ \$1.5 million for the intergenerational childcare facility at Maranatha House
- ✓ \$1.2 million for security CCTV in Wellington and Calare communities
- ✓ \$50,000 for Wellington Library's outdoor reading room



✓ \$12 million in disaster funding for the Duke of Wellington Bridge

ORANGE ELECTORATE OFFICE

1/179A Anson Street Orange NSW 2800
andrew.gee.mp@aph.gov.au

PO Box 673, Orange NSW 2800
www.andrewgeemp.com.au

(02) 6331 0524
@andrewgeecalare

Authorised by Andrew Gee, MP, Suite 1/179A Anson Street, Orange NSW 2800

Wellington’s record flood of 1926: When two rivers met in fury

BY MARIE HOFFMAN

THE WELLINGTON district has known many floods, but none have lived so sharply in local memory as the great inundation of March 1926.

Older residents long compared every rise of the Macquarie or the Bell to that extraordinary event, noting that while the floods of 1870 and 1890 ran close, the 1926 deluge set a record that stood unmatched for generations.

Rain without ceasing

The rains began on 17 March and fell steadily, then violently, across the headwaters of both rivers.

By the 24th, Wellington had recorded 441 points (110.25 millimetres) for the month; by month’s end, the total had reached 948 points (237mm), contributing to an extraordinary 1131 points(282.75mm) for the first three months of the year.

The Macquarie came down first, swollen and swift, followed by the heavier, faster waters of the Bell.

With nowhere to escape, the combined force backed up across the flats and into the town itself.

When the rivers entered the streets

On 25 March, the floodwaters reached the main business area.

Nanima Crescent went under first, the water pushing as far as the Grand Hotel in Lee Street.

At the intersection of Lee and Warne Streets, the water lapped at Kimbell’s Bakery. Along the Wellington–Parkes Road, the Showground became a lake, and boats were rowed where crowds would gather for weeks for the annual show.

Across the junction of the two rivers, an immense sheet of water spread for nearly two miles. In Montefiores, homes near the riverbank were inundated, and families fled as the water rose around them.

Yet, despite the scale of the flood, the damage was less than many feared.

Unlike the raging torrent seen in the Bell earlier that week, the combined floodwaters moved with a slow, relentless force rather than violent speed.

Communities under strain

The Chinese residents farming the Wellington Flats suffered the worst losses.

Their gardens were submerged, their pigs squealing as the waters invaded the enclosures.

Many families were rendered homeless, but townspeople opened their doors, offering shelter until the waters receded.

Small boys, also grown-ups, had the time of their lives in the flood waters of the Bell.

They reaped a rich harvest in watermelons etc. Rabbits were rescued from the water and were enjoyed as a meal and the skins sold to the hide merchant.

Neurea also felt the full force of the flood. The homes of Mr Fuller and the Veech family at Oakleigh were under water, and 11 inches of rain were recorded there for March - five inches falling the night before the flood.

The Neurea Bridge was swept away entirely, cutting all traffic.

Its replacement, built under a cost-sharing arrangement between the



What we know as Larum’s Corner - Warne, Namina Crescent and Lee Streets, 1926 flood.

Main Roads Board and the Council, had since withstood many floods.

Other crossings suffered similar fates. The Scabbing Flat Bridge lost its approaches, isolating traffic from Geurie, while Smith’s Crossing on Curra Creek required urgent and costly repairs.

A town cut off

The Macquarie rose to 50 feet; the Bell to 32.

The waters reached the home of Mr Harry Taylor, who at the time ran a large farm.

Fortunately, all brood mares, foals and stallions were moved to safety before the worst arrived.

Many residents refused to leave their homes even as the waters lapped at their doors.

Ultimately, some were forced to flee in haste, leaving their belongings behind.

The flood had given ample warning, but

not all heeded it. During the height of the emergency, police were called upon to carry out several rescues.

With no official police boats stationed in Wellington - despite the town’s position at the junction of two floodprone rivers - officers relied on privately owned flatbot-tomed boats.

These were not ideal craft for such conditions, and those who used them risked their own safety to save others.

Among the civilians who distinguished themselves were the late Mr C. J. Shakespeare and Mr Jack Riley.

From drought to deluge

The flood came on the heels of a harsh dry season.

Only weeks earlier, stock had perished for want of water and feed, and the countryside had been scorched by bushfires.

The sudden shift from dust to floodwaters rendered many homeless and drowned countless animals.

Horses and cattle left in yards had little chance of escape, though some could have been saved had fences been cut sooner.

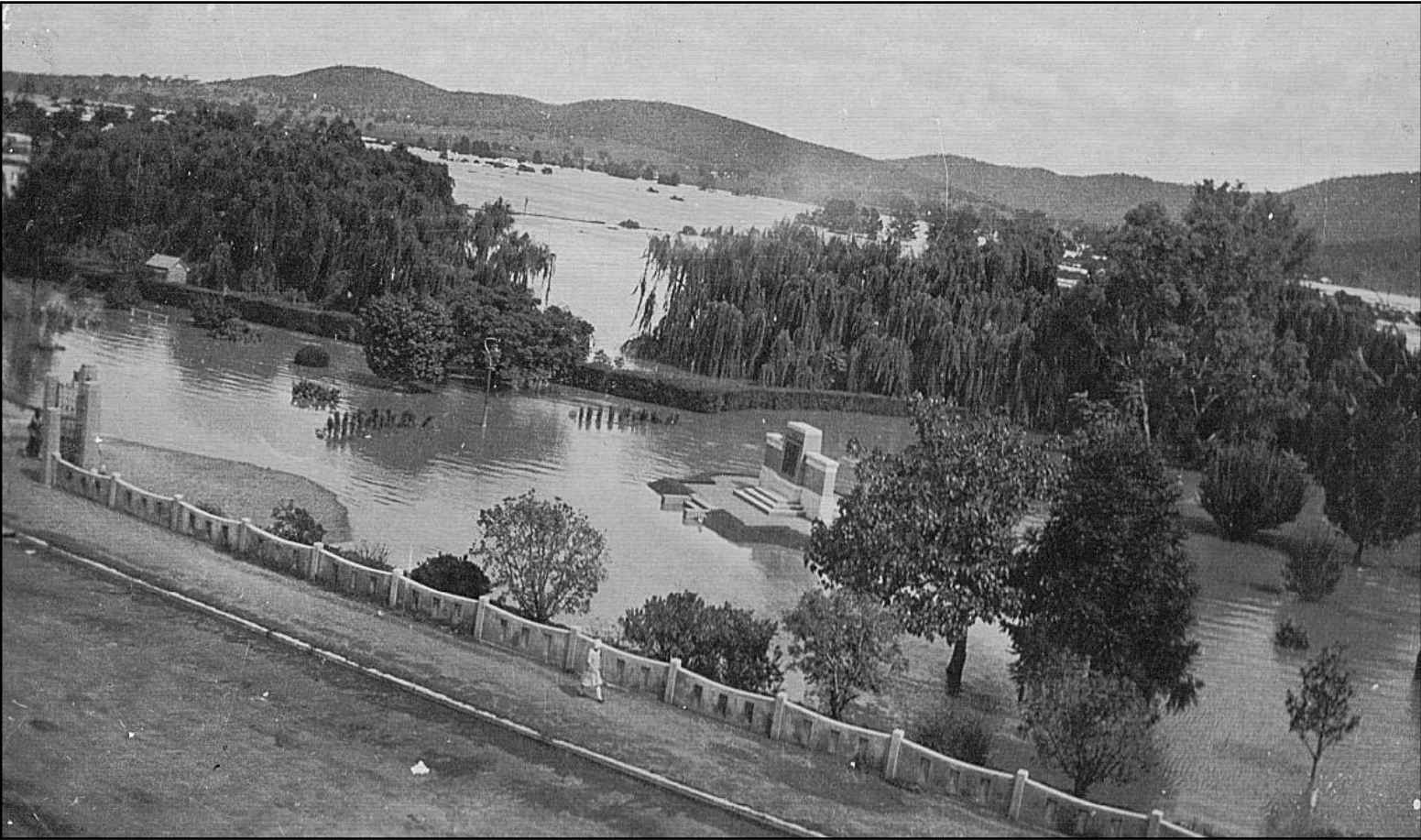
A record that stood

The 1926 flood broke all previous records. Earlier floods had entered the streets easily because the roads lay level with the riverbanks.

By 1926, the streets had been built several feet higher, yet the waters still reached into the business district, surpassing the old marks.

Later that year, The Wellington Times published a calendar featuring photographs of the flood and the Wellington Caves.

The issue sold out on the day of release, prompting a second printing the following Thursday to meet demand.



TV 7 two mate flx NEWS 10 drama Gem comedy SBS 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.55 Creative Types With Virginia Trioli. 11.30 QI. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 Bergerac. Final. 2.00 Parliament Question Time. 2.55 Fake Or Fortune? 3.55 Sister Boniface Mysteries. 4.45 Long Lost Family. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 Back Roads. 8.30 Creative Types With Virginia Trioli. 9.00 Muster Dogs. Final. 10.00 Todd Sampson's Why? 11.05 ABC Late News. 11.20 The Business. 11.35 Late Programs. 7.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 South Aussie With Cosi. 2.30 Air Crash Investigations. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 Medical Emergency. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 Father Brown. 8.30 The Inspector Lynley Mysteries. 10.30 Murdoch Mysteries. 11.30 Late Programs. Entertains 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.30 A Bite To Eat. 3.00 QI. 3.30 Would I Lie To You? 4.05 MythBusters. 4.55 Car S.O.S. 5.40 Portrait Artist Of The Year. 6.30 Richard Osman's House Of Games. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 Tonight At The Museum. 9.00 Gruen. 9.40 Late Programs.	7 mate Family SBS 6.00 Sunrise. 9.00 The Morning Show. 12.00 Seven's National News At Noon. 1.10 Catch Phrase. 2.00 Bridge Of Lies: Celebrity Specials. 3.00 The Chase. 4.00 Seven News At 4. 5.00 The Chase Australia. 6.00 7News Local. 6.30 7News @ 6:30. 7.00 Home And Away. 7.30 Highway Patrol. 8.00 Motorway Patrol. 8.30 MOVIE: Bridget Jones's Diary. (2001) Renée Zellweger, Colin Firth, Hugh Grant. 10.30 To Be Advised. 12.10 Damnation. 1.10 Travel Oz. 2.00 Home Shopping. 4.00 NBC Today. 5.00 Late Programs. 7.00 Morning Programs. 12.30 Pawn Stars. 1.30 Highway Patrol. 2.30 The Force: Behind The Line. 3.30 Mountain Men. 4.30 American Restoration. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.00 Football. AFL. Round 1. Carlton v Richmond. 10.30 AFL Post-Game Show. 11.00 Kick Ons. 11.30 Late Programs. Family 6.00 Kids' Programs. 4.15 Andy's Safari Adventures. 4.40 Vida The Vet. 5.20 Millie Magnificent. 6.05 PJ Masks. 6.25 The Adventures Of Paddington. 6.45 Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. 7.05 Batwheels. 7.35 Ninjago. 8.00 Deadly 60. 8.35 Secrets Of The Zoo. 9.20 Ultimate Vets. 9.50 Animal Park. 10.35 Late Programs.	7 flx NEWS SBS 6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 Married At First Sight. 1.30 Paralympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 5. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 4.30 Tipping Point Australia. 5.30 WIN News. 6.00 9News. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 Rugby League. NRL. Round 2. Brisbane Broncos v Parramatta Eels. 9.55 NRL Thursday Night Footy Post-Match. 10.40 9News Late. 11.10 The Equalizer. 12.05 Tipping Point. 1.00 Hello SA. 1.30 Late Programs. 7.00 Morning Programs. 8.30 Flushed. 9.00 Home Shopping. 10.00 The Great Day Out. 10.30 Farmer Wants A Wife. 12.00 9-1-1. 3.00 Frogger. 4.00 Lopez Vs. Lopez. 4.30 The Connors. 5.30 Bondi Vet. 6.30 Judge Judy. 7.30 Ramsay's Kitchen Nightmares USA. 8.30 Ramsay's Hotel Hell. 10.30 First Dates UK. 11.30 Late Programs. NEWS 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 Parliament. 3.10 ABC News Afternoons. 4.00 Afternoon Briefing. 5.00 ABC News With Joe O'Brien. 6.00 ABC News Hour. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.45 The Business. 9.00 The World. 10.00 ABC Nightly News. 10.30 Foreign Correspondent. 11.00 Late Programs.	10 drama Gem comedy SBS 6.00 Morning Programs. 8.00 Lingo. 9.00 The Finish Line. 10.00 Ent. Tonight. 10.30 Australian Survivor: Redemption. 12.00 Farm To Fork. 12.30 Family Feud. 1.00 News. 2.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 2.30 The Finish Line. 3.30 Lingo. 4.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 5.00 10 News. 6.00 10 News+. 6.30 Deal Or No Deal. 7.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 7.30 Gogglebox Australia. 8.30 The Graham Norton Show. 9.40 10's Late News. 10.40 10 News+. 11.10 The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. 12.00 Late Programs. 7.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Days Of Our Lives. 8.45 The Young And The Restless. 9.30 JAG. 10.30 The Living Room. 11.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 JAG. 3.30 Bull. 4.30 JAG. 6.30 Bull. 7.30 NCIS. 10.30 Bull. 11.15 JAG. 12.15 Home Shopping. drama 6.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Days Of Our Lives. 8.45 The Young And The Restless. 9.30 JAG. 10.30 The Living Room. 11.30 Bondi Rescue. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 JAG. 3.30 Bull. 4.30 JAG. 6.30 Bull. 7.30 NCIS. 10.20 Bull. 11.15 JAG. 12.15 Home Shopping. Gem 6.00 Morning Programs. 1.00 Midsomer Murders. 3.00 Antiques Roadshow. 3.30 MOVIE: The Great St Trinian's Train Robbery. (1966) 5.30 Yorkshire Auction House. 6.30 Antiques Roadshow. 7.30 RBT. 8.30 RPA. 9.30 A+E After Dark. 10.30 Paralympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 5. Replay. 12.00 Late Programs. comedy 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 Family Feud. 10.30 Deal Or No Deal. 11.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 11.30 Becker. 12.00 Frasier. 1.00 The Big Bang Theory. 2.00 Friends. 3.30 Becker. 4.00 Farm To Fork. 4.30 Frasier. 5.30 The Big Bang Theory. 6.30 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 Becker. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs.	SBS comedy SBS 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 WorldWatch. 2.00 MOVIE: Los Hermanos: The Brothers. (2021) 3.30 The Cook Up. 4.05 Vietnam: The Birth Of A Nation. Final. 5.05 Jeopardy! 5.30 Letters And Numbers. 6.00 Mastermind Australia. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.35 Toronto Airport Uncovered. 8.30 The Hospital: In The Deep End. 9.35 A Spy Among Friends. 10.40 SBS World News Late. 11.10 In Memoriam. 12.00 The Hollow. 1.10 Cycling. UCI World Tour. Paris-Nice Race. Stage 5. 3.15 Late Programs. comedy 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 Family Feud. 10.30 Deal Or No Deal. 11.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 11.30 Becker. 12.00 Frasier. 1.00 The Big Bang Theory. 2.00 Friends. 3.30 Becker. 4.00 Farm To Fork. 4.30 Frasier. 5.30 The Big Bang Theory. 6.30 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 Becker. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs. comedy 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 Family Feud. 10.30 Deal Or No Deal. 11.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 11.30 Becker. 12.00 Frasier. 1.00 The Big Bang Theory. 2.00 Friends. 3.30 Becker. 4.00 Farm To Fork. 4.30 Frasier. 5.30 The Big Bang Theory. 6.30 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 Becker. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs.	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Stage 6. 3.15 Late Programs. comedy 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 Family Feud. 10.30 Deal Or No Deal. 11.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 11.30 Becker. 12.00 Frasier. 1.00 The Big Bang Theory. 2.00 Friends. 3.30 Becker. 4.00 Farm To Fork. 4.30 Frasier. 5.30 The Big Bang Theory. 6.30 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 Becker. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs. comedy 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 Family Feud. 10.30 Deal Or No Deal. 11.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 11.30 Becker. 12.00 Frasier. 1.00 The Big Bang Theory. 2.00 Friends. 3.30 Becker. 4.00 Farm To Fork. 4.30 Frasier. 5.30 The Big Bang Theory. 6.30 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 Becker. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs.	SBS comedy SBS 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 WorldWatch. 2.00 MOVIE: The Hospital: In The Deep End. 3.00 Nula. 3.30 Going Places With Ernie Dingo. 4.00 The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. 4.30 Jeopardy! 4.55 Letters And Numbers. 5.25 Mastermind Australia. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.30 Going Places With Ernie Dingo. 8.30 Fukushima: A Nuclear Nightmare. 10.05 Rock Legends. 10.35 SBS World News Late. 11.05 Sisi. 12.05 How Sports Changed The World. 1.10 Cycling. UCI World Tour. Paris-Nice Race. Stage 6. 3.15 Late Programs. comedy 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 Family Feud. 10.30 Deal Or No Deal. 11.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 11.30 Becker. 12.00 Frasier. 1.00 The Big Bang Theory. 2.00 Friends. 3.30 Becker. 4.00 Farm To Fork. 4.30 Frasier. 5.30 The Big Bang Theory.
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5x5 No. 382

Insert the missing letters to make 10 words – five reading across the grid and five reading down.

D		S		S
	N		R	
C	N			E
	N		O	
D		S		S

Edgeword No. 234

Place each of the tiles of letters into the blank jigsaw below to create four six-letter words going across and down.

SECH

RYUI

EE NT

CR OU

There may be more than one possible answer.

Crossmath No. 232

Insert each number from 1 to 9 in the shaded squares to solve all the horizontal and vertical equations. Multiplication and division are performed before addition and subtraction.

	+		-		=	6
×		×		+		
	×		×		=	112
×		-		+		
	×		+		=	55
=		=		=		
90		22		12		

Solutions

ENTRY
CHERRY
CRUISE
CROUCH
EDGEWORD

S	K	S	E	D
M	O	D	N	E
E	O	N	V	C
T	R	I	N	I
S	C	S	I	D

SXS

	12		22		06	
	=		=		=	
55	=	1	+	9	×	6
		+		-		×
112	=	8	×	7	×	2
		+		×		×
6	=	3	-	4	+	5

HMVSSOR

TV

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** Landline. **2.00** Spicks And Specks. **2.25** Anh's Brush With Fame. **2.55** Fake Or Fortune? **3.55** Murdoch Mysteries. **4.45** Long Lost Family. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** Australian Story. **8.30** Four Corners. **9.15** Media Watch. **9.35** Planet America. **10.05** Foreign Correspondent. **10.40** ABC Late News. **10.55** The Business. **11.10** The Weekly With Charlie Pickering. **11.40** Late Programs.

two

6.00 Morning Programs. **1.30** The Zoo. **2.00** Weekender. **2.30** Auction Squad. **3.30** Harry's Practice. **4.00** Medical Emergency. **4.30** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.30** Escape To The Country. **6.30** Bargain Hunt. **7.30** Doc Martin. **8.30** A Touch Of Frost. **10.50** Ambulance: Code Red. **11.50** Late Programs.

Entertains

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.05** ER. **2.50** QI. **3.20** MythBusters. **5.00** Car S.O.S. **5.45** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **6.30** House Of Games. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** Penn & Teller: Fool Us. Final. **9.15** Whose Line Is It Anyway? Final. **9.35** Elementary. **10.20** Late Programs.

7

6.00 Sunrise. **9.30** Oscars Red Carpet. **10.00** The Oscars. **1.30** Border Security: International. **2.00** Bridge Of Lies. **3.00** The Chase. **4.00** Seven News At 4. **5.00** The Chase Australia. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6:30. **7.00** Home And Away. **7.30** Australian Idol. **9.10** The Oscars. **12.40** The Agenda Setters: Rugby League. **1.40** The Agenda Setters. **3.00** Home Shopping. **4.00** NBC Today. **5.00** Sunrise Early News. **5.30** Sunrise.

mate

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.30** Boating. Circuit Boat Drivers C'ship. **3.30** Mountain Men. **4.30** American Restoration. **5.00** Storage Wars. **5.30** American Pickers. **6.30** Pawn Stars. **7.30** The Agenda Setters: Rugby League. **8.30** Aussie Gold Hunters. Return. **9.30** Outback Opal Hunters. **10.30** Aussie Salvage Squad. **11.30** Late Programs.

Family

6.00 Kids' Programs. **2.45** The Makery. **3.00** Play School. **3.40** Thomas And Friends. **4.15** Andy's Safari Adventures. **5.20** Millie Magnificent. **6.05** PJ Masks. **7.05** Batwheels. **7.35** Ninjago. **8.00** Deadly 60. **8.35** Gladiators UK. **9.35** Kids BBQ Championship. **10.15** Kids Baking Championship. **10.55** Late Programs.

9

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** Married At First Sight. **1.30** Paralympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 9. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** Married At First Sight. **9.00** 100% Footy. **10.00** 9News Late. **10.30** Paralympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026 Closing Ceremony. From Stadio Olimpico del Ghiaccio, Cortina d'Ampezzo, Italy. Replay. **1.00** Late Programs.

flix

6.00 It's Academic. **7.30** Kitty Is Not A Cat. **8.30** Flushed. **9.00** Home Shopping. **10.00** The Great Day Out. **10.30** Farmer Wants A Wife. **12.00** 9-1-1. **3.00** Australian Idol. **4.50** The Conners. **5.30** Bondi Vet. **6.30** Judge Judy. **7.30** Law & Order. **8.30** Law & Order: Criminal Intent. **9.30** Law & Order: SVU. **10.30** Bones. **12.30** Late Programs.

NEWS

6.00 Morning Programs. **3.00** ABC News Afternoons. **4.00** Afternoon Briefing. **5.00** ABC News With Joe O'Brien. **6.00** ABC News Hour. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** ABC News Tonight. **8.45** The Business. **9.00** The World. **10.00** ABC Nightly News. **10.30** Planet America. **11.00** ABC Late News. **11.30** Late Programs.

10

6.00 Morning Programs. **8.00** Lingo. **9.00** The Finish Line. **10.00** Ent. Tonight. **10.30** Australian Survivor: Redemption. **12.00** GCBC. Return. **12.30** Family Feud. **1.00** News. **2.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **2.30** The Finish Line. **3.30** Lingo. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.00** 10 News+. **6.30** Deal Or No Deal. **7.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **7.30** Australian Survivor: Redemption. **8.40** Matlock. **9.40** 10's Late News. **10.40** 10 News+. **11.10** The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. **12.00** Late Programs.

drama

6.00 Home Shopping. **8.00** Days Of Our Lives. **8.45** The Young And The Restless. **9.30** The Living Room. **11.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **12.00** Days Of Our Lives. **12.45** The Young And The Restless. **1.30** JAG. **3.30** Bull. **4.30** JAG. **6.30** Bull. **7.30** NCIS. **8.30** Fire Country. **9.25** NCIS. **10.20** Bull. **11.15** JAG. **12.15** Home Shopping.

Gem

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** David Attenborough's Planet Earth III. **1.00** Shakespeare And Hathaway. **3.00** Antiques Roadshow. **3.30** MOVIE: The Halfway House. (1944) **5.30** Yorkshire Auction House. **6.30** Antiques Roadshow. **7.30** Death In Paradise. **8.40** The Brokenwood Mysteries. **10.40** Coma. **11.40** Late Programs.

SBS

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.10** WorldWatch. **1.00** PBS News Compass Points. **1.30** WorldWatch. **2.00** Love In The Walls. **3.10** Freedom Is A Verb. **3.30** The Cook Up. **4.05** Ancient Builders Of The Amazon. **5.05** Jeopardy! **5.30** Letters And Numbers. **6.00** Mastermind Australia. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.35** Inside The Tower Of London. **8.30** 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. **9.25** Never Mind The Buzzcocks. **10.10** SBS World News Late. **10.40** Other People's Money. **11.35** Late Programs.

comedy

6.00 Morning Programs. **10.00** Family Feud. **10.30** Deal Or No Deal. **11.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **11.30** Becker. **12.00** Frasier. **1.00** The Big Bang Theory. **2.00** Friends. **3.30** Becker. **4.00** Farm To Fork. **4.30** Frasier. **5.30** The Big Bang Theory. **6.30** Friends. **8.00** The Big Bang Theory. **10.00** Becker. **10.30** Frasier. **11.30** Late Programs.

VICELAND

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.05** Over The Black Dot. **2.35** Stories From The Cities. **3.05** WorldWatch. **4.00** PBS News Compass Points. **4.30** WorldWatch. **5.00** Alone. **6.10** Arabia's Best Kept Secrets. **7.05** Jeopardy! **7.35** 8 Out Of 10 Cats. **8.30** Holy Marvels. Return. **9.20** Greatest Escapes. **10.10** Late Programs.

TV

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** Death In Paradise. **2.00** Spicks And Specks. **2.30** Anh's Brush With Fame. **3.00** Fake Or Fortune? **3.55** Murdoch Mysteries. **4.45** Long Lost Family. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** Foreign Correspondent. **8.30** Todd Sampson's Why? **9.00** If You're Listening: Black Swans. Final. **9.35** Creative Types With Virginia Trioli. **10.05** Compass. **10.35** ABC Late News. **10.50** The Business. **11.05** Four Corners. **11.50** Late Programs.

two

6.00 Morning Programs. **1.30** The Zoo. **2.00** Creek To Coast. **2.30** Escape To The Country. **3.30** Harry's Practice. **4.00** Medical Emergency. **4.30** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.30** Escape To The Country. **6.30** Bargain Hunt. **7.30** Call The Midwife. **8.45** Judge John Deed. **10.45** Dark City: The Cleaner. New. **11.45** Late Programs.

Entertains

6.00 Morning Programs. **3.05** QI. **3.35** Would I Lie To You? **4.05** MythBusters. **5.00** Car S.O.S. **5.45** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **6.30** House Of Games. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** Small Town Scandal. **8.55** Can You Keep A Secret? **9.25** Elementary. **10.10** Late Programs.

7

6.00 Sunrise. **9.00** The Morning Show. **12.00** Seven's National News At Noon. **1.10** Blankety Blank. **2.00** Bridge Of Lies. **3.00** The Chase. **4.00** Seven News At 4. **5.00** The Chase Australia. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6:30. **7.00** Home And Away. **7.30** Australian Idol. **8.30** Doc. **9.30** Ambulance: Code Red. **10.30** The Agenda Setters. **11.30** St. Denis Medical. **12.00** Dirty John. **2.00** Home Shopping. **4.00** NBC Today. **5.00** Sunrise Early News. **5.30** Sunrise.

mate

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.30** Pawn Stars. **1.30** Aussie Gold Hunters. **2.30** Outback Opal Hunters. **3.30** Mountain Men. **4.30** American Restoration. **5.00** Storage Wars. **5.30** American Pickers. **6.30** Pawn Stars. **7.30** Outback Truckers. **8.30** Cape Carnage: Killer Catch. **9.30** Outback Truckers. **10.30** Railroad Australia. **11.30** Late Programs.

Family

6.00 Kids' Programs. **3.40** Thomas And Friends. **4.15** Andy's Safari Adventures. **5.20** Millie Magnificent. **6.05** PJ Masks. **7.05** Batwheels. **7.35** Ninjago. **8.00** Deadly 60. **8.35** Deadly 60. **9.05** The Slow Mo Guys' Big Adventures. New. **9.25** MythBusters "There's Your Problem!". **9.50** BattleBots. **10.35** Late Programs.

9

6.00 Today. **9.00** Today Extra. **11.30** 9News Morning. **12.00** Married At First Sight. **1.30** Getaway. **2.00** Pointless. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** Married At First Sight. **9.00** The Hunting Wives. **10.00** 9News Late. **10.30** The Killer Interview With Piers Morgan. **11.30** Next Stop. **12.00** Tipping Point. **1.00** Destination WA. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **2.30** Our State On A Plate. **3.00** Late Programs.

flix

6.00 It's Academic. **7.30** Kitty Is Not A Cat. **8.30** Flushed. **9.00** Home Shopping. **10.00** The Great Day Out. **10.30** Farmer Wants A Wife. **12.00** 9-1-1. **3.00** Australian Idol. **4.50** The Conners. **5.30** Bondi Vet. **6.30** Judge Judy. **7.30** CSI: New York. **8.30** CSI: Crime Scene Investigation. **9.30** CSI: Miami. **10.30** CSI: New York. **11.30** Late Programs.

NEWS

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.25** Interest Rate Decision. **3.00** ABC News Afternoons. **4.00** Afternoon Briefing. **5.00** ABC News With Joe O'Brien. **6.00** ABC News Hour. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** ABC News Tonight. **8.45** The Business. **9.00** The World. **10.00** ABC Nightly News. **10.15** Four Corners. **11.00** Late Programs.

10

6.00 Ent. Tonight. **6.30** Bold. **7.00** Deal Or No Deal. **7.30** GCBC. **8.00** Lingo. **9.00** The Finish Line. **10.00** Ent. Tonight. **10.30** Australian Survivor: Redemption. **11.40** Farm To Fork. **12.00** GCBC. **12.30** Family Feud. **1.00** News. **2.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **2.30** The Finish Line. **3.30** Lingo. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.00** 10 News+. **6.30** Deal Or No Deal. **7.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **7.30** Australian Survivor: Redemption. **9.00** NCIS. **10.00** 10's Late News. **11.00** 10 News+. **11.30** Late Programs.

drama

6.00 Home Shopping. **8.00** Days Of Our Lives. **8.45** The Young And The Restless. **9.30** JAG. **10.30** The Living Room. **11.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **12.00** Days Of Our Lives. **12.45** The Young And The Restless. **1.30** JAG. **3.30** Bull. **4.30** JAG. **6.30** Bull. **7.30** NCIS. **8.30** Fire Country. **9.25** NCIS. **10.20** Bull. **11.15** JAG. **12.15** Home Shopping.

Gem

6.00 Morning Programs. **11.00** Worst House On The Street. **12.00** Death In Paradise. **1.00** The Brokenwood Mysteries. **3.00** Antiques Roadshow. **3.30** MOVIE: Charley Moon. (1956) **5.30** Yorkshire Auction House. **6.30** Antiques Roadshow. **7.30** New Tricks. **8.40** Agatha Christie's Marple. **10.40** Harry Wild. **11.40** Late Programs.

SBS

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** WorldWatch. **2.00** The Song Cycle. **3.30** The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. **4.00** Brendan Gleeson's Farewell To Hughes. **5.05** Jeopardy! **5.30** Letters And Numbers. **6.00** Mastermind Australia. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.30** Great Continental Railway Journeys. **8.30** Insight. **9.30** Dateline. **10.00** Rock Legends. **10.30** SBS World News Late. **11.00** Exit. **11.55** Wolf. **2.10** Safe Home. **3.10** Blood Money: Inside The Nazi Economy. **4.05** Late Programs.

comedy

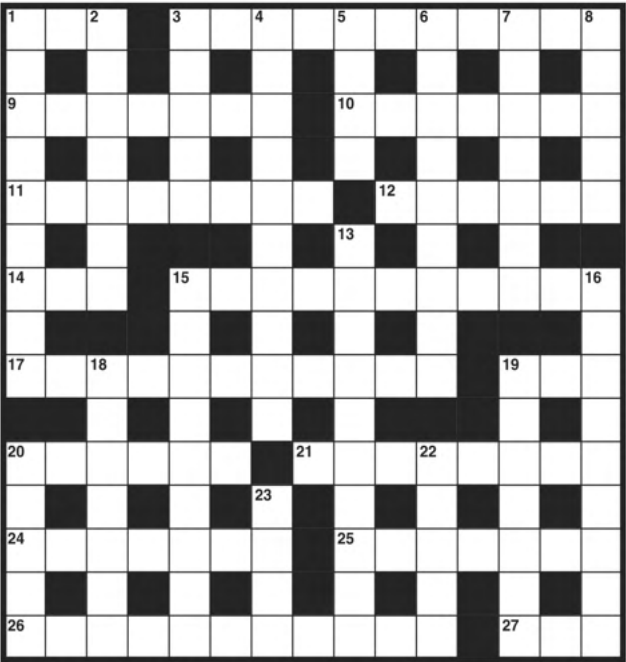
6.00 Morning Programs. **10.30** Deal Or No Deal. **11.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **11.30** Becker. **12.00** Frasier. **1.00** The Big Bang Theory. **2.00** Friends. **3.30** Becker. **4.00** Good Chef Bad Chef. **4.30** Frasier. **5.30** The Big Bang Theory. **6.30** Friends. **8.00** The Big Bang Theory. **10.00** Becker. **10.30** Frasier. **11.30** Late Programs.

VICELAND

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.35** Fashionista. **2.55** WorldWatch. **4.55** Alone. **6.10** Arabia's Best Kept Secrets. **7.05** Jeopardy! **7.35** 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. **8.30** James May: Our Man In... Japan. **9.25** Into The Void: Life, Death And Heavy Metal. **11.15** Brassic. **1.05** WWE Legends. **2.40** Late Programs.

CROSSWORD

No. 167



ACROSS

- 1 Mother (3)
3 Deportation (11)
9 Family name (7)
10 Deliver commentary (7)
11 Abstained from (8)
12 Positive aspect (6)

- 14 Earth (3)
15 Members (11)
17 Punishment (10)
19 State of agitation (3)
20 Body (6)
21 Shoeless (8)
24 Exude (7)

- 25 Arabic derivative of Abraham (7)
26 Series of events (11)
27 Sprinted (3)
- DOWN**
- 1 Courier (9)
2 North African country (7)
3 Delete (5)
4 Approximately (10)
5 Blemishes (4)
6 Sudden violent invasion (9)
7 Fantasise (7)
8 Sibling's daughter (5)
13 Process of turning on (10)
15 Specify (9)
16 Athlete (9)
18 Cyclone (7)
19 An addition (7)
20 Crawl (5)
22 EU currency (5)
23 Historical alcoholic drink (4)

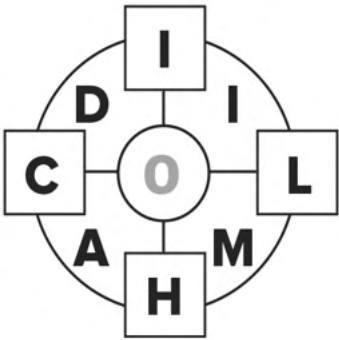


9-LETTER

No. 167

Using the nine letters in the grid, how many words of four letters or more can you list? The centre letter must be included and each letter may only be used once. No colloquial or foreign words. No capitalised nouns, apostrophes or plural words ending in "s".

- Today's Aim:
12 words: Good
18 words: Very good
24 words: Excellent

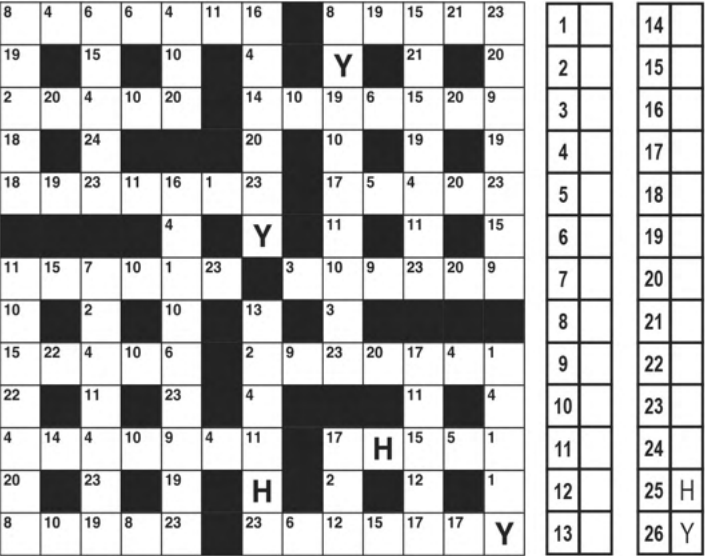


- modal, moll,
macho, millo, mocha,
loam, loch, loci,
ldiom, idol, lido, load,
holm, HOMICIDAL,
domicil, halo, hold,
cola, cold, coma,
clod, coal, coda, coil,

CODEWORD

No. 117

Each number corresponds to a letter of the alphabet. Two have been filled in for you, can you work out the rest?

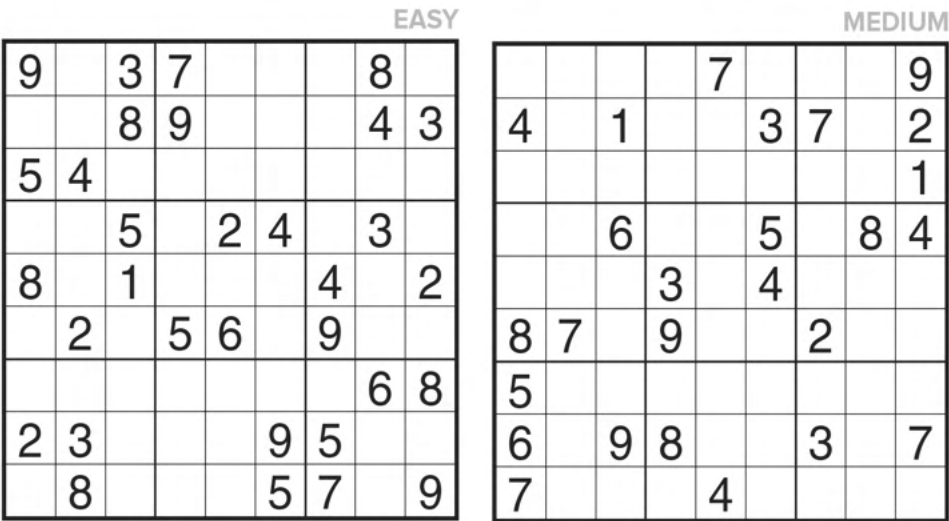


13 = Q, 14 = D, 15 = A, 16 = F, 19 = S, 17 = K, 18 = R, 20 = N, 21 = V, 22 = X, 23 = E, 24 = Z

SUDOKU

No. 167

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every number from 1 to 9 must appear in: each of the nine vertical columns, each of the nine horizontal rows and each of the nine 3 x 3 boxes. Remember, no number can occur more than once in any row, column or box.



QUICK QUIZ

- Who was the 'Kool' in Kool & the Gang?
- What shape is a honeycomb cell?
- The *Lady Juliana* was the first ship to arrive in Australia after the First Fleet. What was she transporting?
- In what year was comedian Andy Lee (pictured) named Cleo Bachelor of the Year?
- In Maori legend, what became the North Island of Aotearoa?
- What two colours feature on the flag of Tunisia?
- In what Australian state or territory is the satellite tracking station Pine Gap?
- What material, used in touchscreens, is reportedly running out?
- Writer Samuel Langhorne Clemens was better known by what pen name?
- What does the technological acronym HDMI stand for?

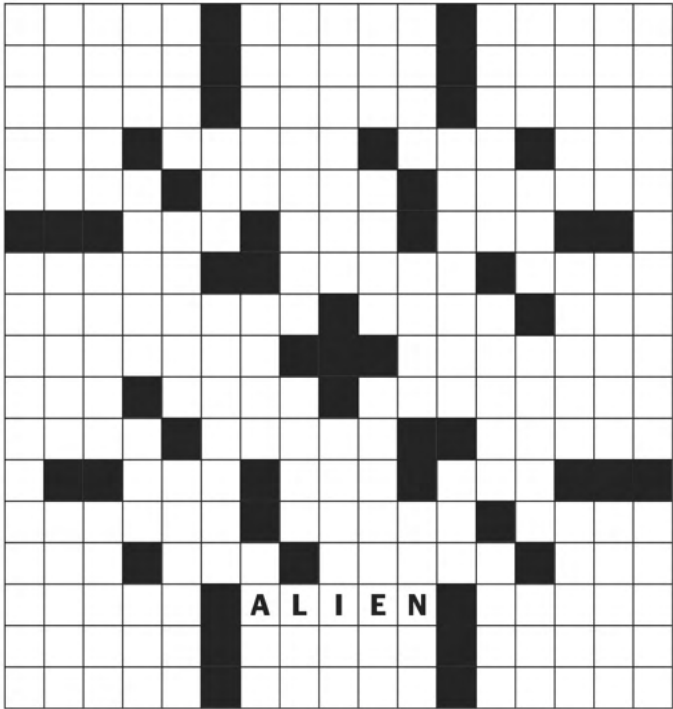


ANSWERS: 1. Robert Bell 2. A hexagon 3. Female convicts 4. 2006 5. A giant fish 6. Red and white 7. Northern Territory 8. Indium tin oxide 9. Mark Twain 10. High-Definition Multimedia Interface

WORDFIT

No. 077

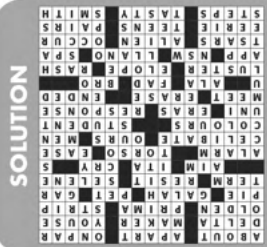
- 3 LETTERS**
- AIM
ALA
APP
ARM
BEN
BRO
CAM
CRY
FAD
GAR
ITA
LEA
LYE
MEN
NOT
NSW
PET
PIE
REM
RIP
SPA
TAT
UNI
UTE
- 4 LETTERS**
- EASE
ERAS
MEET
OOPS
OURS
RASH
SAFE
SUSE
TANG
TARO
TERM
- 5 LETTERS**
- TRAP
TSAR
WATT
- 6 LETTERS**
- SENSE
SMITH
SPARE
SPURT
STEPS
STRIP
SUPER
TASTY
TEENS
TORSO
TSARS
UPSET
YOUSE
- 7 LETTERS**
- AKIHITO
ARREARS
COLOURS
ESCORTS
SALLIES
STUDENT
- 8 LETTERS**
- CELIBATE
PARASITE
REDOLENT
RESPONSE
- 11 LETTERS**
- ACCUMULATES
REPRESENTED



- SENSE
SMITH
SPARE
SPURT
STEPS
STRIP
SUPER
TASTY
TEENS
TORSO
TSARS
UPSET
YOUSE

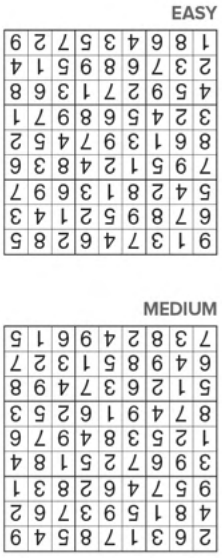
- 6 LETTERS**
- LENSES
LUSTER
OYSTER
SELENE
- 7 LETTERS**
- AKIHITO
ARREARS
COLOURS
ESCORTS
SALLIES
STUDENT

- 8 LETTERS**
- CELIBATE
PARASITE
REDOLENT
RESPONSE
- 11 LETTERS**
- ACCUMULATES
REPRESENTED



PUZZLES AND PAGINATION © pagemasters.

SOLUTIONS



WORD SEARCH

No. 077

Can you find all the words listed? The leftover letters will spell out a secret message.



- A STAR IS BORN
AIDA
ALADDIN
ANNIE
CABARET
CANDIDE
CATS
CHICAGO
EVITA
FAME
GIGI
GREASE
HAIR
- JERSEY BOYS
KINKY BOOTS
MAMMA MIA
MAN OF LA MANCHA
MARY POPPINS
NINE
OKLAHOMA
OLIVER
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SECRET MESSAGE: Why speak it when you can sing it

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AGRI TOPICS

Information for the Man on the Land

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ANOTHER WEEK without useful rain. The week will see plenty of cloud but minute amounts of rain. ***

ANZ Agri in focus (continued from last week). WOOL:- The eastern market has started the year strongly, pushing up over 1700c/kg clean. Lack of supply is the key factor pushing prices higher and the latest forecast from late December of a lower national clip has led to this year’s climb.

The most pronounced price increases have been for medium wool, where supply has suffered most significantly. Increasing diversification of export markets for Australian wool is also supporting some sustainability in prices.

The most pronounced growth has been in the mid-micron market which has been hit the hardest by flock selloffs. In the longer term, while wool suits sales continue to be anaemic, the wool industry is making the successful transition to blended, sustainable fabrics with excellent sustainability credentials. LAMB:- 2026 has generally started well for the national lamb and sheep market, if not with the spectacular prices seen last year. There seems to be some stability in the current market. The benchmark National Trade Lamb indicator entered February just under 3% higher than it rounded out 2025, while most other categories also sit higher.

Light and restocker lamb categories have shown very slight growth of around 2% while Merino lambs are up around 5%. The downside is heavy lambs, with the national heavy lamb indicator now sitting around 15% lower than August 2025 highs and slightly lower than where it ended 2025.

I believe this position will reverse this month as our export of lighter lambs went mainly to the Middle East now at war, the heavier lambs are mainly consumed domestically. ***

Markets at a Glance

WOOL.. Sydney 5th. EMI closed 1776c/kg clean, +51cents with 37,212 bale national offering rostered for next sale. Merino f1c solid demand on day 1 producing double digit gains in all mpps, biggest gains in broader >18 mic MPGs, more of the same day 2 with all MPGs rising 22 to 38c. Merino skirtings with low <5% vm rose up to 50c on day1 and 20c to 30c day2. Crossbred firm to lower. Locks and crutchings rose 10 to 20c day2 NRI 1807c/kg clean, up 55c, 1.6% passed-in with 21 bales withdrawn CATTLE.. CTLX 3rd. 3693 head, up 1253. Restockers and lot feeders made up most of sale. Limited fat cattle, most cows secondary condition. Competition strong, mainly light store cattle. Young trade cattle firm to 10c dearer, yearling steers and heifers 420c to 470c/kg. Feeder steers lifted 10c, 433c to 539c/kg, heifers 20c dearer, 418c to 470c/kg. Weaner steers to restockers to 568c, heifers to 498c/kg. Grown cattle firm to dearer, heavy steers 420c to 464c/kg, heifers 345c to 488c/kg, secondary cows 12c dearer, 2 and 3 scores 288c to 400c, heavy cows 388c to 416 c/kg. Heavy bulls to 423c/kg. SHEEP.. CTLX 4th. 2075 sheep (-355) lambs 4545 (+225). Mainly light store lambs, limited supplies of trade and heavy lambs. Large rainfall across the region limited supply, so prices considerably dearer across all grades. Light processing lambs to 18kg \$140 to \$234. Trade 20kg to 24kg up to \$20 dearer, \$244 to \$299. Heavy lambs over 24kg gained \$20 to \$25, \$288 to \$344. Carcase price ave 1160c and 1230c/kg cwt, heavy hoggets reached \$270, light lambs to restockers to \$260. Mixed quality mutton held firm, Merino ewes \$70 to \$197. Xb ewes \$135 to \$292. Merino wethers \$130 to\$227 .Rams to \$170. PRODUCE.. Canola and wheat set to rise on the world market whilst barley to stay firm. *** Stock clearance continues



Plasto & Company

Livestock and Property

Stock report by Ross Plasto

DUBBO CATTLE:- 7100, up 2700. Large numbers of cows in store condition, also weaners suitable for restockers. Northern and southern restocker support provided very strong competition on store cows and weaners. Young trade cattle 12c dearer, yearlings 440c to 491c/kg. Feeder steers and heifers firm to 8c/kg dearer. Feeder steers 458c to 513c, heifers 392c to 481c/kg. Young cattle to restockers up to 55c dearer, steers to 588c, heifers to 498c/kg. Grown steers and heifers 8c to 10c dearer, steers 410c to 488c/kg, heifers 448c to 476c/kg. Cows to processors 2c to 5c dearer, restocker cows considerably dearer. 2 and 3 score cows to processors 260c to 376c, heavy cows 372c to 410c, ave 396c/kg. Cows to restockers 270c to 426c/kg. Heavy bulls 20c dearer to 430c/kg. DUBBO LAMB:- 14,425. Light lambs under 18kg \$8 to \$13 stronger, mostly \$150 to \$215. Trade weights jumped \$25 on ave, very little supply, \$216 to \$276, ave 1100c to 1140c/kg. Heavy lambs lifted \$10 to \$15, \$260 to \$334 or 1080c/kg on ave. Extra heavy reached \$379. Heavy Merinos to \$278, hoggets \$325.60. MUTTON:- Numbers also lifted and the quality mixed, prices strengthened through sale ending \$5 to \$7 stronger on most. Medium weight ewes \$134 to \$213, heavy crossbred ewes to \$314, Dorpers \$266. Most ranged 730c to 800c/kg cwt. STORE CATTLE:- March sale, small yarding 357. As expected, solid support from the north and south, limited local interest. Young steers from \$400 for Brahmans to \$1500 for Angus, heifer

weaners \$425 for very light and young crossbred calves to \$1300 Angus. Angus heifers spring 2024 drop depastured to Angus bulls to calve next August \$1820. The cow and cow /calf markets \$200 to \$300 dearer than previous sale. Best pen of Angus cows with first calves 4 to 5 months old, depastured to Angus bulls to calve in August \$3110/unit, middle aged Hereford cows with large calves \$2790/unit. Balance of cows/calves \$1630 for small framed Murray Greys to \$2220 for Black Baldies with young calves. Dry cows store condition \$1200 to \$1830. WOOL:- Week prior’s 50,000 bale offering failed to slow the market and it continued to accelerate last week despite Middle East events. A 1.8% drop in the USD v AUD exchange rates and a lower offering assisted proceedings. Prices were dearer in the Northern region on Tuesday playing a little bit of catch up to the South who sold in isolation on Thursday. By first day close the NRI had climbed 35 cents. Wednesday’s further increases of another 20 cents added with the NRI climbing 3.1% for the week. Price increases were localised to the Merino offering with the crossbred sector giving back some ground. This is the highest closing weekly level of the broad-based Eastern market indicator in almost seven years. It traded higher during a 12-month period of the 2018-19 season before first shipping concerns and then COVID hit. 36,442 bales were sold with a small passed-in rate of 2.1%. Major buyers Techwool, PJ Morris and Endeavour Wool. This week’s offering predicted to fall just under 46,000 bales.



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WEEKLY MARKET REPORT

Week ending March 6, 2026

AWEX Northern Micron Indices Comparison

AWEX INDEX	This Week 536/25	This Week M36/25	Last Sale 535/25	Sydney Change	Last Year Sydney	Sydney Yearly Change
17	2375	2398	2326	+49	1730n	+645
18	2318	2333	2241	+77	1618	+700
19	2217	2201	2112	+105	1529	+688
20	2105n	2112	2029	+76	1476n	+629
21	-	2090	2004	-	-	-
26	888n	889	895	-7	592n	+296
28	702n	695	720	-18	415n	+287
MC	1004n	1029	968	+36	735n	+269

No resistance yet

AN OFFERING of 37,212 bales last week had little resistance from the trade with the exception of crossbred wools. On the first selling day the market was stronger across the board with Merino fleece indicators up between 24 and 67 Cents. This trend continued on second day with19 microns the clubhouse leader, up 105 cents for the week. The passed-in rate reflected the strength of the sale at just 2.1%. This was the tenth consecutive selling day that the EMI has posted positive gains, and it now sits 542 cents or 44.2% above the same week last year. Despite the offering being 60,000 bales less compared to last year the gross sales of wool is nudging \$300m more in grower’s pockets year to date. A quick glance at the market in May/June 2018 is reasonably sobering as we still have a long way to go to reach the resistance points of the day in both AU and more so in US dollar terms. In the past two strong runs, 2011 and 2018, the resistance level in US dollars was just over an EMI of 1500 US cents.

Today we sit at 1237 US cents with the dollar at similar levels to 2018 and way below that of 2011.

If you dissect the market into microns then the coarser end of the Merino sector is still 150-250 cents below the peaks of June 2018 and over 500 cents below for the 17-micron indicator.

The reasons for this stronger premium for 19.5 microns and coarser are simple. Since 2001 the Australian clip has declined by 369 million kilograms (mkg) or 83% in the 19.6 to 24.5 micron production. At the same time, we are producing 56.6mkg or 50% more of 19.6 micron and finer.

This only exacerbated during extended dry periods similar to what we went through in 2018 and are going through now. The current question is, where is the next resistance level? I don’t believe we’re ready for that next step yet as this latest sharp increase seen since Christmas is yet to be shipped, processed and on-sold down the pipeline. We’re not that far off an EMI of 1800 cents and I don’t think we would be unhappy if it took a breather and consolidated around those levels. Macwool and Carmichael had a combined catalogued 2164 bales on Tuesday, in a national total of 45,973 bales over the three selling centres.

YOUR WOOL IN SAFE HANDS

Around the tracks with Col Hodges

Racing at Dubbo

KRANICH AND Western Warrior emerged as good prospects for the \$150,000 Evergreen Turf-WRA Country Championship Qualifier (1400 metres) next Sunday when placed behind Crusader Kings in the 1200 metres Preview last Friday at Dubbo.

The Qualifier on Sunday at Dubbo is restricted to horses trained in the western area and Crusader Kings is ineligible after finishing fourth in the Mudgee Qualifier for those trained in the central districts.

In front close to home at Mudgee when overhauled by Tom Vegas, Turned Down and Instead over 1400 metres, the Mark Jones, Mudgee trained Crusader Kings (\$6.50 to \$11) well ridden by apprentice Dale Cole appreciated the step back from 1400 metres to 1200 metres and held off the strong finishing Kranich (Chad Lever, \$6.50) and Western Warrior (Ken Dunbar, \$13) at Dubbo.

From the Rod Northam stable at Scone, Inazuma Boy (Leeshelle Small, \$2 to \$1.85 favourite) looks well above average and recorded the third win in succession when taking out the 1100 metres Latitude Liquor Wholesalers-Benchmark 82 Handicap.

Settling well off the pace, Inazuma Boy swept to the lead in the straight and scored by over 2 lengths from Chandon Star (Jacob Stiff, \$4.40) and How’s It Kev (Jordan Quince, \$16).

Local trainer Janelle Galea had Dunedin very fit for the 2200 assignment in the Weaside Hotel Bottlemart Benchmark 66 Handicap after some good recent performances.

Tracking the leader Testing The Cugat, Dunedin (Leeshelle Small, \$3.70) took over and won by 2 lengths from Will To Excel (Mathew Cahill, \$5.50) and Final Impact (Chad Lever, \$2.40 favourite).

A last start winner at Condobolin Picnics, the Connie Greig, Dubbo trained Just On Fire (Brooke Stower, \$5) was back to TAB company when leading throughout to beat Pappiana (Billy Cray, \$9) and Dark Thinker, Ashleigh McCabe, \$18) in the 1600 metres Castlereagh Hotel BM 58 Handicap.

From nearby Narromine, trainer Kylie Kennedy won the 1600 metres Westside Hotel Maiden Plate (1600 metres) with Lagoon (Heavelon Van Der Hoven, \$7) which finished well from mid-field to beat Muirisc (Zoe Hunt, \$51) and Magic Merlin (Kody Nestor, \$2.35 favourite).

Michael Lynch, a long-time successful trainer at Cowra, supplied the quinnella, Bolo Miss and Bounding Bon in the 1000 metres Col Hodges Cup-Class 1 Handicap..

Ridden to perfection by Mathew Cahill, Bolo Miss (\$3.40) from further back than midfield was in the clear turning for home and raced to a length win over stablemate Bounding Bon (Ken Dunbar, \$14) with the \$3 favourite La Potenza (Kody Nestor) a half neck away third.

Mathew Cahill had earlier led most of the way to win the 1100 metres Maiden Handicap on the James Ponsonby, Hawkesbury trained Claudio (\$5).

The other race, the 1300 metres Super Maiden Handicap was won by Be Guided (Ella Drew, \$3.10 favourite) trained at Muswellbrook by Ben Blay. ***

Unfortunately for the progressive Coonamble Jockey Club, due to water restrictions at Coonamble the \$150,000 Evergreen Turf WRA Country Championship Qualifier has been transferred to Dubbo on Sunday. ***

Following meetings are Warren TAB on Saturday, March 21 and Orange Sunday, March 22.



WELLINGTON RACE CLUB

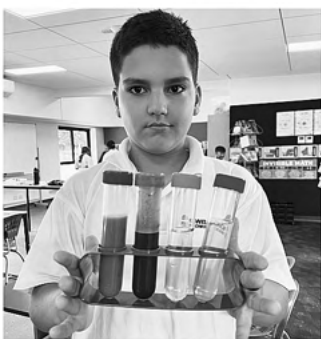


CSSA State Swimming Carnival 2026. We are very proud of our Year 5 student, Ezra Pandey, for competing in the State Swimming Carnival at the Sydney Olympic Park Aquatic Centre in Sydney. Ezra achieved his personal best at the state, surpassing his previous performance at both school and zone swimming carnivals. He had previously achieved a record-breaking feat in the 2025 Swimming Carnival for 8-10-year-old boys in the 50 metre individual medley.

Stage 2 Science. This term in Science, we have been discovering both living and non-living things that God has made. We looked at different things to decide if they can be classified as living or non-living. We have found out that this is not the same as being alive. Scientists classify anything that has lived as part of the group of living things. We discovered that living things, including plants, respire, grow, reproduce, move, respond, take in nutrients, and excrete waste.



Exploring Repeating Patterns. We have started exploring patterns and how they repeat. We have been learning about different types of patterns and creating our own, such as AB, ABB, and ABC patterns. To support our learning and understanding, we have used connector blocks, interactive games on the smartboard, and worksheets. We have also explored patterns in music, using body percussion such as clapping, clicking, and stomping.



Curious Minds at Work! Our Stage 3 scientists rolled up their sleeves for a hands-on investigation exploring which substances dissolve in water. Students tested a variety of materials, including salt, sugar, coffee, and oil, carefully observing what happened in each experiment. As they worked, students also learned the importance of fair testing by managing variables. We discussed the difference between independent, dependent, and controlled variables, and how scientists must keep certain things the same so they can make accurate comparisons. It was wonderful to see the students working collaboratively, recording their observations and thinking like real scientists. Learning through investigation is always exciting, and sometimes a little messy too!



K-2 "The Big Splash" Swimming Carnival. A huge thank you to our parent volunteers and Year 6 student leaders who helped make our K-2 Swimming Carnival a success. A special mention and gratitude to Ogden's Coaches for transporting our students to and from the Wellington Aquatic Leisure Centre.



Wellington Public School

Stage 2



Stage 2 have enjoyed a busy start to 2026. It is an exciting milestone for students as they continue their journey through primary school.

Our children are becoming more confident and independent, embracing new learning opportunities both inside and outside the classroom. They are enjoying a wide variety of activities, from exploring our new English unit 'Fantastic Mr Fox' and participating in collaborative Wiradjuri lessons, to joining in sport, creative arts, and making new friendships. Stage 2 students are thriving at WPS!



Golfing News Centenary celebrations this Sunday

BIG WEEKS of golf keep happening at the Wellington golf course.

And this coming week and weekend will be a highlight with the 100th year anniversary of this great club when celebrations climax this Sunday, March 15 with a full day of fun and entertainment.

To celebrate in golfing style the club will hold a ‘Four-Person Ambrose’ while family fun will be provided at the clubhouse with an all-day barbecue with activities from the youngsters including a putting competition.

At 6pm the club will conduct the Centenary Dinner, a sit-down affair at just \$25 a head.

Ambrose cost is \$25 for golf. Please note, there will be no transport to the golf course, but transport will be available to return home.

Last Saturday’s events were the March Monthly Medal plus the Final and Third place of the Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws Summer Competition as well as the George Hollow Putting Competition.

In the Summer Competition Dirty Birds took on The Masters in a match that was so close that it needed an extra hole to find a winner, so after 19 holes were played it was the Dirty Birds claiming the winner’s prize, commiserations to The Masters on the close loss.

In the playoff for third place it was the Montefiores Maulers that came away with the win over the Bell River Bandits with a 2up victory.

Congratulations to all 14 teams participating this summer, and it will be back on again starting in November.

George Hollow Putting Competition has jackpotted after last Saturday’s golf as Denise Haesler and Rod Pedron tied with 24putts.

Winner of the A grade Monthly Medal was Wayne Lang who had a great day to finish with a 69nett. Runner-up was Paul West who also enjoyed himself to finish with a 70nett on a countback.

Winner in B grade Monthly Medal winner was Brad Conn with the best score of the day a 68nett. Runner-up was Matthew Conn with a 70nett also on c/b.

Prize winners were, Ben Kiss, Josh Bullock 70nett; Elliott McMahon 71; Stephen Whiteman 72; Rob Parnell, Gary McCarroll 73; Elton Keeffe, Denise Haesler Steve Kiss 74; Cody Conn, Nathan Stewart, Gary Cusack, Gareth Petersen, Rod Miller 75netts on c/b.

Nearest the pin on 3rd Gary Cusack, 8th Gareth Petersen, 14th Rob Parnell, 16th Ashley Bullock.

NTP in two-shots on the 7th went to Daniel James Smith.

Longest drives went to Gary Cusack in A grade and Ben Kiss in B grade.

Brent Eather Encouragement award was hotly contested

again last week with only a few shots between a few of the so-called golfers, but it was Allison Brien who came away with the prize with a 90nett on a c/b.

Wednesday had the ladies play their Monthly Medal plus the 9-hole competition. Winner of the Medal was Wendy Slack-Smith with a 71nett while runner-up was Denise Haesler with a 72nett on c/b. Prize winner was Janelle Frappell 72nett and NTP’s were Denise Haesler and Cathy Loo-Shui.

Putting Competition was taken out by Denise Haesler with 25.

Thursday’s Individual Stableford winner was Paul West who finished best on the day on what must have been a difficult day, final score 35pts.

Runner- up was Paul Hannelly with 33pts on c/b. Prize winner was Garry McNaughton 33pts.

Iberdrola, Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club 9-hole after Round 20. Leaders are Joe, Adam, David Ryan, Tim Parker and Gary McCarroll leading with -12.

Last round will now be played on March 19 with the presentation night being on Friday, March 26.

J and B Cup Finals, Matchplay Championships: A grade, Kurt Cusack v David O’Brien, Mitchell Cusack or David East v John Gersbach, John Donnelly v Mathew Redfern, Elton Keeffe v Gary Cusack.

B grade, David Hyde v Daniel McCullum, Rod McMahon v Wayne Lang, Steven McCarroll v Tim Parker, Noel Stanford v Stephen Whiteman.

C grade, Rod Irwin v bye, Warren Williams v John Southwell, Drew Stone v bye, Cody Conn v Ron Cowan.

Round 1 matches are to be played by March 21.

Kiss Trophy draw with Round 1 to be played by March



Joe and Adam Ryan played in the Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws summer competition, as did John Donnelly and Rod Pedron.

14.

B Kiss v Bye, W Bruce v R Cowan, R Baker v Rod McMahon, Brock Naden v David O’Brien, P Neuenhaus v D Stone, D East v P West, D Bell v Pat Slack-Smith, Rod Irwin v Norm Royal, B Eather v Wayne Lang, Kurt Cusack v Bye, J Barton v M Cornish, C Royal v M Ringland, R Pedron v Rod Miller, Nathan Stewart v J Gersbach, N Stanford v G Hollow, D Naveau v M Payne, J Bullock v D Hyde, K Reid v Bye, D Ney v Daniel McCullum, Tim Parker v R Parnell, P Holden v A Ryan, S Whiteman v M Conn, D Haesler v E Keeffe, J Ryan v Bye, J Donnelly v D Wilson, W Slack-Smith v A Brien, J Fleming v A Bullock, J Armstrong v R Agar, G McNaughton v L Conn, M Britton v Gary Cusack, J Southwell v D Ryan, S Kiss v Bye.

Preferred Lies are still in effect through the GREEN.

This Saturday’s events are an Individual Stableford plus Round 1 of the Kiss Trophy.

19th Hole

Around the tracks with Col Hodges

Racing at Tottenham

RETURNING TO form, the Connie Greig trained eight-year-old mare Blackhill Kitty in front of a very big crowd, in a thrilling finish on Saturday, won the 1400 metres Robinson Grain Tottenham Picnic Cup.

A prolific winner of Picnic Cups and twice a runner-up in \$50,000 Picnic Championship Finals, Blackhill Kitty had been well beaten in the recent Cups at Bedgerabong and Condobolin and started as an \$8 relative outsider at Tottenham.

Recovery Road (rails), Ready For Lift Off (centre) and Bobby’s Secret (outside) shared the lead from the outset with Blackhill Kitty, Pickaxe and The Drafter having nice runs off the pace while Lord Percy was slowly away.

The Melissa Harrison, Forbes trained Bobby’s Secret (Paul Zerafa, \$3.50) in a brave performance during a torrid run edged to a narrow lead turning for home but was overhauled in the final stride and beaten a short-half-head by Blackhill Kitty (Leandro Ribeiro, \$8) with a length to the third placed Pickaxe (Ashley Boyd, \$4.60).

Leandro Ribeiro finished second in the opening event and this continued

an uncharacteristic ‘lean’ run for the champion jockey who had ridden five seconds and a third from his previous six rides.

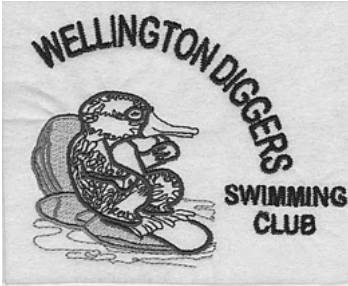
Muswellbrook based Ribeiro however had his many followers cheering again when he rode the last four winners at Tottenham, all being trained at Dubbo by Connie Greig who was backing up after winning with Just On Fire at the Dubbo TAB meeting the previous day.

Formerly from Coonamble and now a successful trainer at Dubbo, Clint Lundholm won the first two races at Tottenham with Swedish Glitter and Bring The Rain.

The speedy Swedish Giltter (\$3.60 fav) with Narromine jockey Ricky Blewitt in the saddle, led all the way when winning the 800m Michael Logan Memorial Class 3 Trophy Handicap from Box Of Crackers (Leandro Ribeiro, \$3.80) and Rubicon River (Dylan Parrott, \$8).

In the 1000m Cutcliffe Family Maiden Plate, Bring The Rain (Ashley Boyd, \$2.20 equal fav) shared the lead with the Greg O’Neill, Nyngan trained Silent Drama (Ricky Blewitt, \$2.20) before a hard-fought win by a head while Uncle Alf (Tamsin Gough, \$10)

Wellington Diggers Swimming Club News



KATHARINE O’ROURKE took out back-to-back 30-metre swims these past two weeks. On Tuesday, February 24 Katharine won the 30-metre event being 0.12 outside her time, while Terry Dray was second and Janelle Frappell and Nick Knowles equal third.

The 50-metre event was won by Wayne Rich being 0.13

outside his time with Katharine O’Rourke second and Di Donnelly third.

Di Donnelly and Nick Knowles won the Brace Relay. On Tuesday March 3 Katharine O’Rourke repeated her 30-metre win being 0.03 outside her time, Nick Knowles was second with Janelle Frappell third.

Janelle Frappell won the 50-metre event being 0.18 outside her time. Nick Knowles was second with Di Donnelly third.

Mason Hill and Darcy Lousick won the junior events while Katharine O’Rourke and Mason Hill won the Brace Relay being 0.25 outside their nominated time.

Results for Tuesday –3 March Juniors

30 Metre: 1 Mason Hil 0.00, 2 Ari Lousick & Rhylee Hill 0.56+, 3 McKenzie George 1.06-.

50 Metre: 1 Darcy Lousick 0.60+, 2 McKenzie George 2.19, 3 Rhylee Hill 3.81+.

Seniors

30 Metre: 1 Katharine O’Rourke 0.03-, 2 Nick Knowles 0.09-, 3 Janelle Frappell 0.28+.

50 Metre: 1 Janelle Frappell 0.18-, 2 Nick Knowles 0.53-, 3 Di Donnelly 0.66+.

Brace Relay: 1 Katharine O’Rourke & Mason Hil 0.25-, 2 Darcy Lousick & Nick Knowles 0.40-, 3 Rhylee Hill & Ari Lousick 1.50+.

The Platypus

Your sport can record results in the “Sport” section. Just contact: mark@wdleader.news

...Tottenham Picnics ..continued.

wound up in third place.

Connie Greig and Leandro Ribeiro then combined to win the remaining four races, starting with Callie Cool in the 1000m Lloyd Jarvis Memorial Open Trophy Handicap.

The Wayne Prisk, Cobar trained Mr Pointer took the early lead with Callie Cool (Leandro Ribeiro, \$1.90 fav) having a good run before winning clearly from Mihrimah (Dylan Parrott, \$6) and Mr Pointer (Tamsin Gough, \$12).

Notleanormean (Leandro Ribeiro, \$4) also camped behind the leaders before beating The

Hoff (Zara Lewis, \$19) and Himeros (Ricky Blewitt, \$1.90 fav) in the Fiveways Legal & Fiveways Hire Class 2 Trophy Handicap.

Following the win in the Cup with Blackhill Kitty, Connie Greig and Leandro Ribeiro completed a big day when Kuroshinzō (\$1.90 fav) fought off a strong challenge from Pluck ‘N’ Spy (Paul Zerafa, \$16) with I Alone (Ricky Blewitt, \$6) third in the 1400m Tottenham Hotel & Combined Businesses Class B Handicap.

Next Picnic meeting is Crookwell on Saturday, March 14.

Col Hodges

Swim Club Championships

- Carmen Gain photos

WELLINGTON AMATEUR Swimming Club held its 2026 Club Championships on Saturday, with a fantastic day of racing and community spirit at the pool.

The championships showcased the enthusiasm and determination of club's swimmers with all competitors congratulated for stepping up, giving their best and displaying great sportsmanship throughout the day.

Feature events of were the prestigious Barton Cup and Arnold Cup races.

In Barton Cup, Lakyn Dowton claimed first place in a strong field, followed by Alex Taylor, second and Roman Dowton third.

Members of the Barton family, Nat, Michael and Peter Barton, were on hand to present the cups, continuing the proud tradition associated with the event.

Arnold Cup winner was Macy Jones her sister, Imogen Jones finishing second and Sophie Wykes third.

Paul Wilson presented the cups on behalf of the Arnold family, helping continue the long-standing connection between the family and the club.

Club officials extends sincere thanks to the many volunteers helping on the day. A special thank you also to Wok and Lil, who cooked a delicious lunch.

Days like the Club Championships are made possible through the efforts of many dedicated volunteers and supportive families, and the club is grateful to everyone who contributed to such a successful event.

Carmen Gain



Touch Grand Finals - Jo Ivey Photos

Exciting finishes as competition season comes to an end



